# 飞渡往日
# Flying to the Past

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# 里斯本光荣
## Glory Days in Lisbon CH19601-01

里斯本光荣
Glory Days in Lisbon

当一个人尝试过飞行的滋味，

他便会时时仰望天空，

看着他曾到访过的地方，

并渴望能够再次回到那儿。
And once you have tasted flight,

You will walk the earth with your eyes turned skyward,

For there you have been,

And there you would return.

1835，里斯本海岸
Coast, Lisbon, 1835

空气中弥漫着柠檬与月桂的淡香。
The air smells of lemon and bay leaves.

西风猎猎作响，自大洋彼岸凶猛袭来，轮船因之被封锁在港湾，加之当局管控，无法出海。
The wind roars in from the Atlantic, but no sails wait to catch it. A military blockade sits anchored at the mouth of the harbor. No ship inside is to depart without permission.

1835 年夏天，里斯本城中人心惶惶，前往新世界的船票一票难求。
It is summer, in the year 1835, and the people of Lisbon, still recovering from years of brutal civil war, are anxious once more. The Queen has banned all passage from the city to the New World.

大海不再向人们敞开，而天空却依旧畅通无阻。
Above the forbidden sea, only the skies offer a possibility of escape.

露西：准备好了吗，希梅娜?
Lucy: Are you ready, Jimena?

希梅娜：没问题！
Jimena: Ready!

露西：三、二、一……
Lucy: Three, two, one—

随着机械女士的倒数号令，她的小助手深深吸了一口气，随后张开双臂——
After the mechanical woman finishes her countdown, her able pilot takes a deep breath and opens her arms.

一对由金属、木材和皮革鼓膜制成的“翅膀”将其延展伸长，拍动着向前奔跑，随后一跃而起。
Artificial wings of metal, wood, and leather deploy out from her back. Flapping them like a bird, she runs toward the water and takes a flying leap.

希梅娜：对了，露西，对了！我飞起来了！
Jimena: Yes, Lucy! We did it! I'm flying!

希梅娜：很好，就是这样，我保持住，保持，保——！
Jimena: I'm flying! Just keep it steady, just ...!

……

...

不走运。这儿又多了一只落水的飞鸟。
The "bird" dives sharply into the water.

露西： 九秒。
Lucy: Nine seconds.

露西： 比上一次的成绩好。
Lucy: An improvement over last time.

露西： 需要帮忙吗?
Lucy: Do you need any assistance?

希梅娜： 呃……谢谢。
Jimena: Ugh, no, thanks.

落水之人爬回海岸，甩甩头发，扯下攀附上肩膀的螃蟹，扔向一旁，再解开摔坏的飞行翼背带，坐在沙滩上叹气摇头。
She moves to unfasten the wings before noticing a crab perched on her shoulder. Returning it to the sand, she crumples down beside it and sighs.

露西： 是风的问题，或者说，动力问题。
Lucy: It appears the primary difficulty is power. The wind is not strong enough, or more precisely, we are not generating sufficient lift.

露西： 再改善一下机械结构，应该可以飞得更久。
Lucy: With further optimizations, we should be able to extend your flight time.

希梅娜： 花了一个月的时间，居然只让滞空时间延长了三秒……
Jimena: This model took a whole month to complete, and it only flew three more seconds!

希梅娜： 这东西真的能行吗？爸爸一定是疯了才会研究这玩意儿……
Jimena: Is it ever going to work? Dad had to be crazy to spend his life like this.

她有些失落，似乎为研究进展如此缓慢而头疼。身后不远处，坐在渔船船头的少年们嘲笑着这出不切实际的闹剧，对她发出一阵阵哄笑。
A gaggle of boys nearby had watched her from their boat. They laughed as she fell, and are still laughing.

落水之人狠狠盯向取笑的旁观者，这才叫那赤裸裸的嗤笑收敛起来。
The girl shoots them an icy glare, a piercing bolt that hits them one by one until each wises up and turns back to their fishing.

露西： 我们只花了一个月的时间，就基于之前的成果提升了百分之五十，这是个不错的成绩。
Lucy: Three seconds represents a 50% improvement in performance. If you take that into consideration, our progress has been remarkable.

希梅娜： 你还真是乐观。
Jimena: Didn't take you for an optimist.

露西： 把衣服擦干，我想我知道问题在哪。
Lucy: Please, you should get yourself into some dry clothes. I believe I have identified the primary issues with the current design.

希梅娜： 照这个速度，一百年之后咱们就能从海角这一边飞到另一边了。
Jimena: Great. At this rate, we might make it from the cape to the shore in, oh, about a hundred years or so.

希梅娜： 不过，我倒是希望能赶紧飞到大海对岸呢！
Jimena: *sighs* If only I could reach the other side of the ocean this very moment!

希梅娜： 想想，这真好……挥着翅膀飞过大西洋，然后稳稳落在新英格兰的温暖海岸，啊！
Jimena: Just think how it would be to fly all across the Atlantic and land on the shores of New England!

露西： 跟上我。
Lucy: We should head back.

希梅娜： 啊，来啦，来啦来啦——
Jimena: Coming.

两人离开城郊海岸，带着被海水浸湿的装备匆匆赶回城市。
Bundling up the soaked machine, the girl and the mechanical woman head back toward the city.

几艘小船浮在外海，仿佛露出海面的鲨鱼鳍，远远巡游海中，伺机而动。
In the distance, the line of warships have resumed patrolling the harbor, their sails jutting up from the water like the fins of hungry sharks.

1835，里斯本港口
Port, Lisbon, 1835

太阳行将落山，城市恢复了它一如往常的喧闹。
As the midday hours turn toward the afternoon, the city begins to bustle with activity once more.

希梅娜： 你觉得是为什么？因为风不够大，还是我太重了？听说亚洲人会玩一种叫风筝的玩具……
Jimena: So, what was the problem you talked about? The wind can't lift me? What does that mean? Am I too heavy? Do you think I'm fat?

希梅娜： 跑着跑着就能靠着风，把纸和木头送上天，在天上飞得又高又远。
Jimena: Have you ever seen kids playing with kites? All you need is a good running start, and the wind just takes them up far into the sky.

希梅娜： 你说我们能不能也整个大风筝，把人送上天?
Jimena: How about we skip birds and just make a great, big, man-sized kite?

她走在机械女士身旁，连哼带笑，不久前的失落似乎被一扫而空，里斯本温暖而吵闹的夜晚让人心情愉快。
They walk together, talking and laughing; their doomed flight soon forgotten—the warmth and energy of Lisbon's streets lifting their spirits where wings had failed.

身旁之人却没有搭理她的问话。金属机械构筑而成的大脑中，正在复盘这次实验的种种细节。
The mechanical woman, however, gives no response. She's replaying the experiment within her metal brain, analyzing it detail by detail.

露西： 应该加上一对辅助翼，在第二关节靠里十厘米的地方。
Lucy: We need a pair of secondary wings installed 4 inches from the second joint.

露西： 翅膀展开后再启动它，风是目前我们唯一可以倚靠的动力。
Lucy: They would unfold after the primary set, in order to balance the lifting force of the wind across your body.

希梅娜： 你在听我说话吗?
Jimena: Are you even listening to me?

小助手跳到机械女士身前，双手叉腰，拦住她的前路。
The would-be pilot jumps into the mechanical woman's way, arms planted on her waist.

露西： 风筝很轻。
Lucy: The structure of a kite is extremely lightweight.

希梅娜：你的意思是，我很重?
Jimena: So, you are calling me fat?

露西：成年人的体重不会比纸和木头组成的玩具轻。
Lucy: I am merely asserting that a grown woman is much heavier than a toy made from wood and paper.

露西：风筝能承载的重量有限，远不如我们的设计。
Lucy: A kite has a very limited payload, and it cannot be directed while in flight. Our model must be able to do much more than that.

坡道尽头传来争吵，随后是士兵的呵斥与醉鬼的谩骂。
An argument breaks up their conversation. From the slope ahead comes a stiff warning and a slurred response.

一队卫兵押送着今夜的“斩获”，钻出酒馆狗洞，用长戟驱赶着“犯人”向市政厅走去。
A squad of soldiers lead their latest "catches" out from the tavern, driving them away down the street.

希梅娜：看来传闻是真的，他们在抓城里的走私犯同伙。
Jimena: Looks like the rumor is true. They are hunting the smugglers' accomplices in the city.

希梅娜：……只要是他们认定与走私犯有关的人。
Jimena: Or, whoever they've decided is an accomplice.

露西：和我们无关。
Lucy: It seems to have little bearing on our situation.

希梅娜：那几个人都是神秘学家，“断臂”费尔南德斯，“金手”卡洛斯，还有“鱼鳃”阿方索……
Jimena: Doesn't it? Just look at who they've arrested. Fernandes the Broken Arm, Carlos the Golden Hand, and Alfonso the Gill ...

小助手一一列出她勉强看清的熟面孔，脸色越发惊惧——每一个都是混迹于港口附近的神秘学家，也都是土生土长的里斯本人，无一例外。
The girl's face grows pale as she keens their faces out from the dark. All of them local arcanists, no exceptions.

希梅娜：当然喽，你又不是这儿的人。国王陛下对外国人向来礼遇有加。
Jimena: Of course, why should it bother you? You're not a local. Her Majesty would never dream of being so unkind to foreigners.

希梅娜：更何况，你还有那个科算中心的介绍信，谁敢跟英国来的客人动粗呀！
Jimena: Besides, you have that letter of introduction from that Computing Center. Who would be so stupid to offend an honorable guest from Britain?!

希梅娜：如果我会飞，我就会从他们头顶上一边笑一边飞过去，让他们抓不到我。
Jimena: But I'm not so lucky. If only I could fly, then if they ever came for me, I would laugh at them from the safety of the skies.

露西：是吗？我只是受科算中心安排来里斯本，出发前他们就办好了全套文件。
Lucy: There was no luck involved. The LSCC sent me here with all the necessary documents to accomplish their interests.

露西：我不关心那些琐事，毫无价值的行政手续。
Lucy: I suppose I had not considered that arcanists here might not have the same privileges I do because of them.

露西：你父亲留下的备用材料在哪里?
Lucy: Returning to our work, where are the spare materials your father left?

希梅娜： 教堂，东边的圣乔治教堂，那儿已经没人了。
Jimena: He kept them under St. George's Cathedral. It's on the east side of the city.

她抱着被海水浸湿的机器，两三步抢到前头，为不熟悉里斯本的伙伴领路。
Carrying the still-dripping gear, the girl seems to forget her prior concerns, running ahead to lead the way.

希梅娜： 帮我盯着点，如果有卫兵，我俩就绕路。
Jimena: Keep an eye out for more of those soldados. We'll make a detour if we have to.

希梅娜： 别担心，那边都是穷人扎堆的地方，老爷们和老爷们的狗不喜欢往东边去。
Jimena: Don't worry. We're going where the Queen and her dogs aren't likely to follow.

但有的狗比别的狗更聪明，也更狡猾，知道在什么地方更能逮到猎物。
However, it seems Her Majesty's dogs have already caught their scent.

露西： 安静。
Lucy: Quiet.

露西： 前面有人。
Lucy: I believe that soldier may be an issue.

如她所说。希梅娜敏捷地转身躲入墙角的阴影下，将手中紧抱着的飞行器塞进机械女士怀中，眨眼间便藏进了公寓土楼构成的迷宫中。
Jimena heeds the warning, passing the wet contraption over to Lucy.

希梅娜： 嘘，前面，露西，我们在那家伙右手边的下一个路口碰头。祝你好运！
Jimena: Shh. I'll meet you at the second junction past the checkpoint. Good luck!

轻声说罢，随着脚步声消失在回廊中，希梅娜的身影也匿入城市的秘密世界，无影无踪。
She whispers her instructions and disappears into a narrow alleyway.

机械女士从卫兵身边走过，而对方显然对她怀中的金属玩意儿更感兴趣。
The sight of a mechanical woman holding a strange dripping machine cannot help but attract attention.

卫兵： 你带的什么东西?
Soldier: Er, what have you got there?

露西： 石头，木头，皮革，布料。
Lucy: But if you must know, metal, wood, leather, fabric ...

以及一枚小小的、象征着遥远日不落帝国之君主王权的双狮纹章。
Not to mention a badge bearing two lions that signifies an empire on which, it is said, the sun never sets.

露西： 用这些组合起来的翅膀。
Lucy: It is a device. Wings.

翅膀。
Wings.

卫兵打量着她和她怀里的东西，一阵沉默后，示意她过去。
The soldier's eyes bulge as he contends with the information, before signaling for her to move along.

机械女士不紧不慢地走过街巷，到约定的地方与同伴碰面。
The mechanical woman continues on unhurriedly toward her rendezvous.

希梅娜： 没为难你?
Jimena: He didn't question you?

希梅娜： 你都跟他说了什么？这么简单就放你过来了?
Jimena: What did you say to him? How come he just let you go?

露西： 我告诉他这是翅膀。
Lucy: He only inquired as to what I was carrying, and I replied honestly: wings.

希梅娜： ……
Jimena: ...

希梅娜： 哈哈哈哈哈哈，他大概当你是个怪人，也不像是要抓的人！
Jimena: Haha, I guess he took you for a weirdo and let you go. You aren't exactly what these dogs are hunting for anyways.

希梅娜： 不过没关系，走不多久就是教堂了，但愿藏在布道台里的东西还没有被那儿的穷人们瓜分了。
Jimena: Anyway, we'll reach the cathedral soon. It's in a spot underneath the pulpit. Well, if no one has cleared it out yet.

露西： 他们要那些东西做什么？
Lucy: Why would anyone do that?

希梅娜： 什么都缺，什么都要，石头可以垒房子，布料和皮革可以取暖，木材可以烧火……
Jimena: The poor are short of everything here. Metal for cookware, fabric and leather for clothes, and wood for their hearths ...

希梅娜： 你能想到的，他们都能用上，尤其现在日子越来越难过……我真想赶紧完成爸爸的遗愿，把这东西造出来，然后带着它去新大陆。
Jimena: They'll use whatever they can get their hands on. I just hope it's still there. I want to fly, to finish what he started, so he can rest, and so I can escape this place.

露西： 恐怕不会很快，还有不少难题要解决。
Lucy: We still have many problems to solve before we get there.

露西： 越来越多的难题。
Lucy: A compiling set.

一个问题引出下一个问题，仿佛藤上生出的新枝，需要一一修剪。
But these problems can be handled, shaped, like pruning the buds on a tree. Solving them one by one until we reach our goal.

希梅娜： 解决一个问题要一个月，那一百个问题岂不是要花上好多年？天哪……
Jimena: And it's taken us a whole month to solve just one. Maybe you've got that kind of time to spare, amiga—Not me.

露西： 你父亲为此花了十年。
Lucy: Your father spent ten years just to get us here.

露西： 以及自己的性命。
Lucy: And he gave everything he had to this project.

希梅娜： 我不明白这是为什么。
Jimena: Yes. He did.

希梅娜： 能够飞到天上去当然很有意思，但是……什么时候才能做到呢？而且，这真的值得吗？
Jimena: Was it worth it? Will it ever be worth it? I know it was his dream and mine, but it feels impossible, or so far away, I'll never live to see it.

露西： 乡绅嘲笑蒸汽车跑得比他们最慢的驮马拉的马车更慢。
Lucy: When they first introduced the locomotive, people laughed at it. It was slower than a horse, and far less practical.

露西： 但我丝毫不怀疑，那些排出滚滚浓烟的机械巨物才是我们的未来。
Lucy: Now, they talk of building railways to connect cities across the continent. Look at their progress. Imagine what might come of them in the future.

希梅娜： 你想说，这个只能在天上飞九秒钟，然后就噗通一下跌下来的翅膀，也是我们的未来吗?
Jimena: And this hunk of junk that's flown a whole nine seconds—you think this is our future?

露西： 是。
Lucy: I do.

她毫不犹豫，也无需思考，她的答案就在她那颗澎湃不息的活塞核心上。
She answers without hesitation. The woman herself is a product of this unstoppable revolution.

希梅娜： 好吧，那我们就去“从前的地方”找找看通往未来的路吧。喏，到了。
Jimena: Alright. Well, we're here. Let's see if we can find our way to this future with whatever is left of the past.

一座教堂，砖墙斑驳，战火摧毁了天使石雕的翅膀，神圣荡然无存。
The two of them arrive at the ruins of a cathedral damaged in the war. A solitary statue of an angel remains, though it has lost its wings, and with them, it seems, all holiness fell away too.

露西： 但愿你父亲留下的东西都还在。
Lucy: I do hope the materials are still intact.

希梅娜： 在布道台底下的密室仓库，你去吧，我到周围打听消息，待会儿就来。
Jimena: There is a cellar underneath the pulpit. Go on ahead. I need to speak to a friend around here. Be right back.

# 风筝牧人
## The Blown Away Kite CH19601-02

风筝牧人
The Blown Away Kite

1835，教堂
Cathedral, 1835

这儿比她想象中更安静。
It's quieter than she imagined.

露西： 风筝……
Lucy: A kite.

露西： 她说得对，风筝……
Lucy: She may be right to consider that ...

机械女士对照设计稿与脑中对纸风筝的记忆，借着烛火，思考着个中关联。
After checking the materials are still in reasonable condition, the mechanical woman begins to reimagine their design with the elements of a kite.

露西： 把底部拓宽。
Lucy: Widen the bottom.

露西： 收窄顶部，对，三角形。
Lucy: Narrow the top, and yes, we get a triangle.

一个优美的几何魔术，让风自下而上托起人类的器械造物。
A wider rigid base should improve their ability to catch the wind.

她将之记录下来，写于纸上，而后看向希梅娜留下的设计稿。
She writes down her idea and looks over the design draft that must have been left by Jimena.

露西： 让气流过去，这样形成一股向上的力，把人和翅膀举起来……
Lucy: That would allow the air to pass above and below the wings to improve lift.

露西： 但如果风向改变，又怎么办？
Lucy: But what if the wind's heading changes abruptly?

她记录下问题，沉思稍许，往图纸上划下一道长长的曲线。
She writes down the question, pondering over the words a while, before drawing a long curve along the draft.

露西： 用一根羽毛尾巴来平衡……这个方案或许可以试试。
Lucy: A feather tail to maintain balance. That may work.

正当机械女士准备动手改造之际，伙伴焦躁的喊声却从教堂门口传来。
The mechanical woman begins planning out the construction, when an anxious voice breaks the silence of the room.

希梅娜： 露西——！
Jimena: Lucy!

露西： 希梅娜？
Lucy: Jimena?

露西： 冷静下来。发生什么事了？
Lucy: Calm yourself. What is happening?

希梅娜： 港口被封锁了！
Jimena: They've locked down the whole port now!

不出意外，抑或说是无关紧要。
An escalation, but not an unexpected one.

露西： 嗯，然后呢？这和我们有什么关系？
Lucy: I see. So? What does it have to do with us?

露西： 港口可以封闭，但海风不受禁令影响。
Lucy: They can stop ships, Jimena, but they cannot stop the wind.

露西： 继续工作，希梅娜，明天傍晚再去海岸试飞一次。
Lucy: Let us just continue our work for now. Tomorrow, we will go to the beach and have another try.

机械女士旁若无事，专心于手中的工作：完成文艺复兴时代的天才留下的遗产。
The mechanical woman's determination is unchanged, even as her companion wavers. True flight must be achieved.

一个关于飞行的狂想，诞生于三个世纪前的米兰城。
They are heirs to a legacy that began in sketches from that enigmatic Italian genius, passed down through centuries, now standing on the cusp of realization.

希梅娜： 卫兵在加紧搜捕，我……露西……我担心……
Jimena: Now there are even more soldiers on the streets. Lucy, I-I'm afraid ...

时局动荡，年轻发明家和机械女士的工作处处受到掣肘，不得不在困境中小步小步试探着前行。
The future of their project hangs on a thread.

露西： 你在害怕什么？
Lucy: What is it that you are afraid of?

希梅娜： 我得想办法去新英格兰，不能待在这儿，否则早晚被他们抓住。
Jimena: That they'll arrest me, Lucy! And only God knows what else, if I stay too long. That I'll never fly—Never reach New England.

希梅娜： 该死，早知道就在封港前跟着费尔南多的船走了……
Jimena: Ah, if I had only gone with Fernando when he left ...

露西： 你打算扔下这些东西吗?
Lucy: Are we just going to leave these materials behind?

粗加工的金属管、木料、煤炭……然后是兽皮与鼓膜，为制造模仿鸟类翅膀而准备的种种材料尽数堆放在这座不起眼的教堂中。
Rough-wrought metal pipes, wood, coal, leather ... All kinds of materials prepared for the project, all lying hidden beneath this ruined place.

里斯本百废待兴，这儿便是不久前撕扯着它的内战伤痕之一。
This cathedral is a scar, a victim of the civil war that had swept through Lisbon not a few years ago. And even in this relatively intact cellar, it is far from an ideal workshop.

露西： 这不是个明智的想法。
Lucy: I believe that would not be a wise choice.

露西： 默多克先生十分支持你父亲提出的这个构想，科算中心和他一样，我们都认为这是个很有前景的项目。
Lucy: Mr. Murdock is very supportive of your father's project, as is the LSCC.

露西： 是你父亲在遗书里向他请求帮助，为此我才受他安排来到里斯本工作。
Lucy: It was your father's letter that brought me here.

露西： 拉普拉斯科算中心对他的研究很感兴趣，瓦特先生去世后，科算中心就很少再有人提出如此充满想象力的方案。
Lucy: We have had few ideas as groundbreaking as this in LSCC since Mr. Watt passed.

露西： 詹姆斯·瓦特……有些同事认为他是我“父亲”，因为在觉醒自我意识前，我是他那台伟大蒸汽机的组成部件之一。
Lucy: James Watt. Some of my colleagues see him as my "father." I had been part of his steam engine before my awakening.

一枚在滚滚浓烟和呜呜轰鸣的蒸汽高歌中诞生的活塞。
She remembers the strange thrill of her first moment of awareness, welcomed by a chorus of steam and whistles.

希梅娜： 父亲……也许吧，我爸爸是个很好的人，他从小就举着我飞，说还要让自己也飞上天。
Jimena: Then I suppose he was in a way, don't you think? We're all built by our fathers, in one way or another. I remember how my dad lifted me up high into the air. He said that someday we'd fly into the sky together.

希梅娜： 是，是，这是个很棒的念头……但我们从没成功过，最好的一次也就飞了几秒钟……
Jimena: It's a beautiful dream. But, he's gone now. He traded his life away for nine seconds.

希梅娜： 我很怀疑到底行不行。做这一切真的有意义吗?
Jimena: I'm not sure that trade will ever be worth it.

露西： 离开地面的每一秒钟都是了不起的成就。
Lucy: Jimena, every second we have spent off the ground is a startling achievement. Not just for you and your father, but for all of history.

机械女士的助手似乎为焦躁所扰，一则受困于迟迟不见进展的研究，二则为变化不定的局势刺激着敏感的神经。
The little inventor frowns, weighing the costs of her dreams and her anxiety for the future.

希梅娜： 那我能用这些翅膀飞过大海，飞到新英格兰去吗?
Jimena: So then, do you think I'll be able to use this to fly away and escape across the ocean?

露西： 不能。
Lucy: No.

露西： 横渡大西洋的唯一方法是乘船。
Lucy: For the foreseeable future, the only way across the Atlantic is by ship.

希梅娜： 但大船都被扣押在港口里。
Jimena: And with the port locked down, there's really no way at all.

希梅娜： 等等，也许还有转机……
Jimena: Wait, there may still be a chance!

希梅娜： 大船走不了，海岸上还有小船可以用！我去联系一下熟人，待会儿海岸见——
Jimena: I have to speak to someone; I'll see you on the beach tomorrow.

话音刚落，希梅娜便转身离开，绕过教堂侧边的小门，快步消失在城市的夜幕中。
She scarcely finishes her thoughts before she's bounded up and out into the streets.

露西： 希梅娜——
Lucy: Jimena!

她总是这样。来去如风，像她将要骑乘的无形之风，匆匆往来，却也因此而无法望向远方。
That's what she has been like—a gust of wind—always moving, flying too fast to see what lies ahead.

教堂重归寂静，纸笔交响的声音旋即又回荡在这神圣之地。小小的插曲没能打断机械女士的思路。
Silence returns, broken intermittently by the rhythmic scratching of pencil on paper.

露西： 必须减轻金属材料的重量，但要保证整体结构的强度……
Lucy: A lighter alloy could lower the weight without reducing structural strength.

露西： 铝。
Lucy: Aluminum.

她想到了这个唯一的，但又昂贵得难以承担的答案。
It would work perfectly, if only the material were not beyond unaffordable.

露西： 不，这个方法行不通。
Lucy: No. Not worth further consideration.

当她陷入苦思时，全副武装的士兵们闯入教堂。
不怀好意的来客却只见到孤零零的机械女士一人。
Lost in her thoughts, Lucy manages to miss entirely the squad of soldiers as they enter the ruins and find her alone.

她的思绪与目光都聚焦于跟前的稿纸和密密麻麻的演算数字，不速之客的到来似乎与她毫无关联。
As she marks down measurements and theories, they at last announce their presence.

卫兵： 藏在这里的其他人呢?
Soldier: You, woman, where is she?

露西： 不要打扰我计算。
Lucy: Could it wait for a moment? I am in the middle of some calibrations.

几个同伙大步上前，将她团团围住。机械女士的双手却依旧撑着身下的木桌，继续思考着陷入困局的推算。
The soldiers surround her, yet she takes little notice.

卫兵： 我们不想在上帝的屋舍下发生不愉快的冲突。
Soldier: Please, senhora. We don't want to cause any violence under God's roof, even in its current state.

卫兵： 那个走私犯的女儿去哪了?
Soldier: We only need to know where the smuggler's daughter has gone.

露西： 限制左翼的是第二关节的强度，只要在这里再加上一块辅助翼，风力的利用效率或许能比先前更好。
Lucy: The secondary joints will be under the most stress, that will limit our maximum wing span. Unless, we might add an additional set.

她立刻在纸上标注出一块圆圈。
She marks a spot on the draft with a circle.

卫兵： 我们耐心有限。
Soldier: You're testing our patience, senhora.

刀刃直穿纸张，将墨水画下的圈靶和纸下木桌钉在一块儿。
A dagger pierces through the circle on the draft, pinning it to the table.

机械女士缓缓抬头，看向身前这个面相凶狠的男人。
She raises her head to meet the man. Jimena was right. He bears a striking resemblance to a snarling dog.

露西： 教堂里没有人。
Lucy: There is no one else here.

露西： 你们要找谁?
Lucy: Who were you looking for again?

卫兵： 那个走私犯的女儿!
Soldier: The smuggler's daughter!

露西： 很遗憾，先生们，你们或许找错地方了。
Lucy: I am afraid you are what is the phrase: "barking up the wrong tree?"

卫兵： 少**跟我耍滑头，把她交出来。
Soldier: No more funny business, senhora. Give me her location, now!

露西： 我不能交出一件我没有的东西，这在逻辑上是矛盾的。
Lucy: A logical impossibility. I cannot give you what I do not possess.

士兵抽回短剑，趁势将桌上的几张稿纸扯碎。
The soldier draws back the dagger roughly, ripping the draft apart.

机械女士蹲下身，一点点捡回纸张的碎片，在烛光照映下，耐心将其就地拼回原样。
Lucy picks the pieces up and calmly begins puzzling them together.

露西： 请离开这里。
Lucy: Please leave.

露西： 你们在浪费时间。
Lucy: You are wasting your time.

她抬头，仰视着这些不知所措的士兵，看出了钢铁面盔下的动摇。
对方没有十足把握，似乎只是凭着依稀的线索才找上门来。
She can sense their hesitation; their snarls starting to sound a little more like whines.

露西： 除了纸和笔，这里什么都没有，先生们。
Lucy: All I have here is pencil and paper. There is nothing else, senhor.

卫兵： 这个也是吗，啊？什么也没有?
Soldier: What about this, huh? You call that nothing else?

年轻人的冲动就像横行于半岛王国的公牛般，暴烈而突然。
The young soldier seizes the winged contraption, then throws it to the ground.

军靴踏碎了她带回的木质框架，木块折碎，金属骨架随之弯曲断裂。
Like a bull unleashed from its pen, he stomps over any breakable piece he can find.

卫兵： 走，到别的地方去找！
Soldier: She's not here. Let's go! Vamos, rápido!

不速之客如来时那般匆忙离开，留下一地混乱。
Her uninvited guests file out, tails between their legs, leaving the mess they've caused behind.

机械女士默不作声，将设计稿和破损的飞行器拾回桌面，重新收拾起一切。
而她从来不缺耐心。
Wordlessly, the wings are picked up from the ground and placed onto the table.
It will be repaired, just as it had been many times before.

她取出备用零件，熟练地修复起受损的飞行机器。
The mechanical woman draws out some spare materials and begins her work.

# 伊卡洛斯

## Icarus CH19601-03

伊卡洛斯
Icarus

希梅娜： 呼……他们走了。
Jimena: Phew! They're gone.

露西： 你父亲留下的东西帮了不少忙。
Lucy: Your father's materials proved useful.

露西： 很快就能修好。调整一下，明天试飞。
Lucy: It will not take long to finish these repairs and make some adjustments. We will still be able to perform another test flight tomorrow.

希梅娜： 这么说还是有好消息的，我也有消息……
Jimena: So, it's not all bad news. Still, I have something to tell you.

说到这里，她却有些不好意思开口。
She stops, hesitating to continue.

希梅娜： 我打算先离开里斯本。
Jimena: I'm leaving Lisbon.

露西： 嗯。那飞行器呢?
Lucy: I see. And your flying machine?

希梅娜： 先就这样吧，我可以带到新大陆去继续研究，带着它和我们的设计稿……
Jimena: Leave it be. I'll take it and our drafts to the New World and continue the project there.

露西： 也就是说，我出局了?
Lucy: So, you have no further need of me, then?

希梅娜： 我不是这个意思……
Jimena: That's not what I meant.

露西： 如果你在那边能更好地完成这件事，那么祝贺你，希梅娜。
Lucy: If that means the project can be completed without further distraction, then I suppose I should welcome it. Congratulations, Jimena.

机械女士停下手头的活儿，望向助手。
The mechanical woman stops her work abruptly and turns to her would-be test pilot.

希梅娜：十五分钟后会有船在海边接我，他们答应好了。我想带着东西离开。
Jimena: I've made a deal to secure my way out of here. I'm going to the beach; there'll be a boat waiting for me there.

露西：但我认为留在里斯本会更好。
Lucy: And you will be going to the New World? That would be unwise.

露西：欧洲有更多资源供我们使用，新英格兰什么也没有。
Lucy: You have access to many more resources here in Europe. To start over in New England would cause unnecessary delays.

希梅娜：但在这儿我随时可能跟那些家伙一起去蹲监狱，我可不想……
Jimena: And you'd have me stay in Lisbon? Where I could be arrested at any time?

露西：不想?
Lucy: So, you will leave? Even if that puts the project in jeopardy?

机械女士感到不解。
The mechanical woman's words sound like an accusation.

希梅娜：我说了，我可以把这些东西带到新大陆去，这个研究没问题，我自己一个人也可以……
Jimena: I'll take all the materials with me, and our drafts. A delay, maybe, maybe a long one, but nothing I can't handle. I'll be fine.

徒劳的狡辩。
Her confidence fades.

希梅娜：再说了，这是我父亲留给我的遗产，你看，这些是我的，而不是你父亲留给你的，不是吗？只是因为他给英国朋友写了信，所以你才来帮我……我可以……
Jimena: Besides, this is my father's legacy, MY FATHER'S, not yours. You're only here because of him. This is my decision to make, it's my dream—our dream ...

一个谎言，为了体面，也为了求生。她在动摇。
The words taste like a lie.

她在害怕。
She's scared.

露西：你父亲留下了一个梦想给你，而瓦特先生留给我的则是这枚活塞。
Lucy: Your father built you a dream. Just like Mr. Watt's done for me.

露西：他希望我离开实验室，走出斯塔福德郡的工坊，去见见更多的人，倾听更多的思想与想象。
Lucy: He wanted me to leave the laboratory to meet more people, to listen to them, and understand their ideas, their imaginations.

露西：通过合作，人类才得以狩猎大型猎物，进而形成聚落，制造工具。
Lucy: He believed in the power of human cooperation. That an idea could be passed from hand to hand, like a torch or an ember, across generations.

她指向自己身体的核心。一个永恒的理念，一种不竭的活力。
She points at the core of her body, that very idea had come to life in her.

露西：没什么好担心的。我们的合作已经让这个梦想距它出发时走出了很远。
Lucy: Thanks in part to our cooperation, our project has already come so far from where it started.

希梅娜：我看不到成功，更不觉得为这个飘渺的希望继续坚持下去有什么好处……露西……我……
Jimena: That's true. But things have changed. If there were some glimmers of success, something I could hold on to, maybe, but ...

希梅娜：九秒钟和六秒钟有什么区别呢?
Jimena: What's the difference between six seconds and nine?

面对提问，机械女士没有作答。她收起设备，将机翼折好，走向教堂大门。
Lucy packs the wings wordlessly and walks to the door.

希梅娜： 露西……
Jimena: Lucy ...

露西： 现在风况很好，抓紧时间，希梅娜。
Lucy: The wind is nearing optimal conditions. We should seize this final opportunity to test our work before you go.

露西： 风力远不足以让这样的结构支撑起成年人的体重，腾空飞起。
Lucy: With our current technology, wind alone will not provide sufficient force to lift a human in a sustained or directed flight.

露西： 或许在精巧的结构设计和自然力的支持下能实现短时间的滑翔。
Lucy: But a controlled glide may be possible, with the right materials.

两人走向海岸，行将离别之际，却像过去那样讨论着飞行机器的设计。
Despite knowing that they will soon part, the only thing they can speak about is their project.

希梅娜： 风车？还是水车？难道要用像你一样的蒸汽吗？
Jimena: Like a windmill? Or a water wheel? Will it use steam, like your power source?

露西： 坦白说，我不知道。加装蒸汽机或许是可行的方案，但那太重了。
Lucy: Perhaps. A steam engine would generate a great deal of force, but it would be far too heavy to be feasible.

露西： 在这之外，神秘术也是一条可行之道。
Lucy: There is one more option: arcanum.

希梅娜： 神秘术？别……别……
Jimena: You mean arcane skill? No, absolutely not!

希梅娜连连摇头，似乎为这个词而恐惧，犹如旧日的幽灵从唇齿间的发音中被唤醒。
She goes pale, as if the idea had conjured some long-forgotten nightmare.

露西： 嗯，神秘术不能从根本上解决问题。
Lucy: I know. Arcanum could not be a long-term solution.

露西： 这条路上没有捷径可走，不可能每一次起飞都依赖神秘术的辅助。
Lucy: It would be impractical to have an arcanist stand by for every flight, after all.

希梅娜： 你跟我认识的其他神秘学家同胞都不太一样……
Jimena: I don't think you really understand what other arcanists go through in this world.

露西： 同胞？
Lucy: What do you mean?

希梅娜： 我的家族以前都在船上干活，就是用我们的神秘术替走私船预测风向和海况。
Jimena: As you no doubt heard from those soldiers, my family were smugglers. Or, really, all we did was predict the direction of the wind and sea conditions, for fishermen, sailors, and for smugglers, too.

希梅娜： 直到一次失误。总之那是个糟糕的事故……爸爸为此丧命，那时候他就是为了做这对翅膀，才去新英格兰采买材料。
Jimena: My father was guiding a ship out. He went with them this time, I guess, to buy some fancy new materials. But something went wrong. There was a storm. The survivors called him a "Jonah." They decided it was his fault.

一个误判，一次海难，一场对幸存者的私刑。
Her face falls, looking stuck somewhere between anger and grief.

露西：这是一种迷信，就像水手认为出海时不能向陆地回头。
Lucy: Your father did not control the weather; he only predicted it. He should not have been blamed. That was ignorance, superstition.

露西：为什么会诞生这些规则？这种极小幅度的肢体动作不会对船舶航行造成任何影响。
Lucy: Like sailors that refuse to look back as they leave port. Their motions have no true impact on the safety of the ship. It is only a mistaken belief.

希梅娜：因为那意味着你还没有准备好拥抱大海，还没有胆子迎接大海的挑战。
Jimena: You don't understand, Lucy. They do it because looking back means that you are not ready to leave. And the sea is quick to punish those that cannot face it.

露西：自然世界应当不存在智慧生命才具备的情感功能，希梅娜。
Lucy: The sea does not punish. It has neither feelings nor intelligence. It cannot know, nor would it care, what the sailors do.

露西：这是人类的一厢情愿。
Lucy: Superstition is only a false comfort.

希梅娜：是人类以及神秘学家的一厢情愿。
Jimena: But a comfort they'll still value against the vast and unpredictable sea. We can't help ourselves, humans and arcanists alike.

露西：把更多精力花在改善海航器械上，会比浪费在这些毫无价值的仪式上更有价值。
Lucy: But it has no value at all. How much effort and time is wasted on these useless ceremonies? It could be more efficiently used for securing ropes or advancing marine technology!

希梅娜：一个不安的水手是没办法在船上好好干活的。人们信神，从而得到力量。
Jimena: A sailor can't do his job properly if he's thinking of home. If nothing else, people gain courage from their beliefs.

露西：力量在于他们的经验和凝聚着航海技术精华的机械造物，以及适当的好运。
Lucy: They would be able to feel more courageous if they focused on gaining experience, and properly utilizing technology. Everything else is simply mechanistic fate. Luck, not belief.

好运，是的，总会在恰到好处的时候溜走的、狡猾的好运……
Random luck at that. It couldn't be controlled, only computed.

海岸的另一端，追猎着神秘学家的火光一如刚才那般向两人走近。
But as luck would have it, at that moment, lights spring up from the other side of the beach, carried by soldiers moving swiftly toward them.

卫兵：她在海岸上！
Soldier: There, on the beach!

希梅娜：该死！他们来得比船快！
Jimena: No! No, the boat is late.

沙滩空空荡荡，先前停靠岸边的小舟都已经遁入大海，而与她约定的船只却不见踪影。
She realizes as she says it: it isn't late; it was already gone, along with any other boat that has a chance of getting through the tightening blockade.

希梅娜：船呢？船为什么还没靠岸……
Jimena: Where are they?

手足无措的神秘学家看向深蓝大海，灯塔光亮扫过海面，一只只小船正驶向远方，或停在海面。
The panicked arcanist scans her eyes across the sea, picking out distant shadows of sails speckled against the horizon.

她得自己想办法渡过数百米大海，飞上迎接她的船只的甲板。
They must be a mile out from her and gaining distance fast.

她听见金属碰撞的响声越发接近，军靴践踏海岸，仿佛猎狗紧追的咆哮。
And behind her, marching boots thud over the sand, gaining ground just as quickly.

露西： 还有一个办法。
Lucy: There is still something we can do.

露西： 把飞行器给我。
Lucy: Let me see the machine.

这并非科学的成功，也并非研究的成就，而只是一个权宜之计。
True scientific achievement will have to wait, but this will provide a temporary solution.

神秘术的辉光显现，蒸汽随机械女士的活塞核心运转而轰鸣着排出，将那层覆满奥秘的铁青色涂上机翼。
The light of arcane skill flashes as Lucy's piston starts to churn. She pours out a blast of steam, causing the wings to stiffen and change into an iron-gray metal.

希梅娜： 这、这是什么？你从没跟我说过这个！
Jimena: Wh-what is this? You never told me you could do anything like this!

希梅娜： 你对它……做了什么……
Jimena: What did you do to it?

露西： 也许能让你飞起来，我不敢保证。
Lucy: This may be strong enough to keep you in the air, but I cannot make any guarantees.

金属翅膀随风扇动，像是展翅待飞的雏鹰，将希梅娜赶往海岸。
Jimena dons the now metallic wings, flapping them like a fledgling eager to take off.

露西： 控制好高度，然后向最近的那艘船飞去。
Lucy: Control your altitude, and aim as best as you can for the nearest boat.

露西： 压低身子，尽量与海面平行。
Lucy: You must lie flat and keep your body parallel to the water.

希梅娜： 如果我落水了，他们会把我抓走的！
Jimena: What if I fall?

露西： 你留在这里，也会被带走。
Lucy: Then they may catch you, but you will be caught if you stay here.

希梅娜忐忑不安，这时却也只能相信伙伴，迈步跑向大海。沿途踩下的脚印，旋即便被冲上沙滩的海浪吞没。
Lucy is right. There is only one way out, and she must take it. Nervous feet find their pace. She runs toward the sea.

她挥打着双臂，踩过浪花，在海水没过膝盖时奋力跃出——
Extending her wings, she leaps with all her strength up and over the water.

露西： 展开手臂，压低身体，保持平衡。
Lucy: Arms open, body flat, and stay balanced.

希梅娜： 露西——！
Jimena: Lucy!

她不安地振翅飞起，滑向高高的远天，风却稳稳地接住了远行之人。
The wind lifts her up surely and steadily.

她离海平线上的落日越来越近，离陆地母亲却越来越远。
Jimena's stomach churns as she makes for the horizon, chasing toward the bare outlines of masts against the setting sun.

船桅的形影将要消失在大海尽头，机械女士不确定她那位同伴是否平安落到了甲板上。
From the beach, there is no more sign of the little pilot. No way to know whether she landed safely. Against all odds, the mechanical woman finds herself hoping her friend did not look back.

机械女士望向翱翔于海天之间的那只飞鸟，希梅娜似乎颇为惊讶这期盼多时的自由。
A seabird skims over her from the darkness of the sea toward the lights approaching from the beach.

她在风中摇荡，摇摇晃晃飞向远方的航船。
Jimena's flight is a little unsteady at first, but she flies. No one can take that from her now.

露西：她飞走了，先生们，你们来迟了一步。
Lucy: She has flown the coop, gentlemen.

卫兵：你放走了她?
Soldier: And you just let her go?

露西：不，我和你们一样，无力阻止一位能飞上天空的逃亡者。
Lucy: I am under no obligation to catch her. Besides, how could I?

卫兵：开火！把她打下来！
Soldier: Ay! Find her! Swim if you've got to! Vamos!

来自英格兰的客人并非卫兵的猎物。看到伙伴飞走，机械女士没能为这“成功”高兴。
The soldiers pay the woman no mind as they rush up the ridge to get a better view, nor does she mind them. Her little bird is long past where they could reach her.

依靠自己的神秘术完成的飞行奇迹，并非她所渴望见到的。
Though arcane skill was not how either of them had envisioned achieving it.

机械女士就此转身离去，走回海岸尽头的城镇。
里斯本城墙上灯火通明，她隐隐能够听见港口吹起的长号声。
The mechanical woman heads back toward the city walls, lost in thought, scarcely noticing the blaring horns ringing out across the port.

露西：我们做过很多尝试。
Lucy: We have tried so many designs.

露西：从材料到结构，从结构再到数学的魔术，直到神秘术这条不可复制的捷径。
Lucy: A variety of materials, shapes, structures, countless formula adjustments, and yet only arcane skill proved sufficient—a shortcut—one wholly unreliable in any practical application.

露西：她做得很好，却停在了路的半途。
Lucy: They had made so much progress, only to part without a solution.

如同一只被耗尽了耐心的惊弓之鸟，将梦想抛诸脑后，依靠着不可复制的奇迹匆忙逃走。
Jimena. That frightened little bird—she could not blame her, though she wanted to. All this so she could escape and leave her with nothing, not even a working theory.

机械女士停下脚步。没有人来追赶她，身后的士兵向着天空开枪，徒劳地瞄准远远飞走的希梅娜。
Crackling shots ring out from the beach, the soldiers firing vainly into the sky as their captain rages. But Jimena is well beyond sight now, and the reach of their shot.

海潮涨起又退下，螃蟹从沙坑里爬出，举起蟹钳敲击着挡在身前的“钢铁巨物”。
As if to bring her back to her senses, a tiny crab crawls out of the sand and snaps at her feet.

露西： 嗯？徒劳的击打，你想要我让开，是吗？
Lucy: Hmm? You want me to step aside, am I right?

露西： 嗯，坚硬的几丁质有机物，但它的强度对金属表壳来说没有意义。你的重量和体积都不足以对这副身躯造成伤害，节肢动物。
Lucy: Your chitin is certainly harder than most things, but no match for metal. An arthropod of your size simply does not have the size or strength to damage me.

她蹲下去，抓起螃蟹，细细地端详一阵后，又将其放回盐湿的海岸，水浪不多久便将这小小的造物卷入大海。
She catches the crab gently, scanning it for a moment before allowing it to scurry away into the sea.

那只离岸的海鸟已经飞了太久，没有任何一根命运的丝线将希梅娜与大地或大海相连。
It disappears beneath the waves, just as her friend did in the evening sky.

海鸟滑翔空中，如同一只随风逐流的水母，飘向比落日更远的远海，朝着离港的航船追去。
Never to come back.

露西： 要找到一条真正可行的道路，人类无可避免地要为此付出代价。
Lucy: I let you cheat. But to find a real workable solution, there will be a price to pay.

露西： 时间、信心和勇气。
Lucy: It will take time, determination, and courage.

露西： 但现在，你放弃了，希梅娜。
Lucy: And now you chose to give up, Jimena.

# 大都会
## Metropolis CH19601-04

大都会
Metropolis

1908，维克多的工作室
Victor's Workshop, 1908

露西： 维克多，燃油储备还剩多少？
Lucy: Victor, how much gasoline is left?

维克多： 照现在的用量，下周末就得见底了，但还能支持我们做几次测试。
Victor: Enough for a few tests, but we'll run out by next weekend.

维克多： 公司那边会送货过来，但最好还是省着点用，这东西最近涨价涨得很快。
Victor: Don't worry. Our investors will send us another barrel before that. Still, we'd best use it sparingly. This stuff is expensive.

满手油污的先生算着日子，从浸满燃油味的桌上拨开日历。
The engineer turns the page on his calendar, staining it with oil.

几张笔迹混乱的设计稿被随意钉在墙上，以便工程师随时修改。
Several drafts are pinned to the wall, each marked with notes and proposed changes.

露西： 管道强度不够，温度继续升高可能会出问题。
Lucy: This pipe will not be enough. It may warp if the temperature is not controlled.

露西： 我不能保证热力转输时连接管能保持稳定，或许该加增外壳，提高容错。
Lucy: There is no guarantee of stable heat transfer. Perhaps we should add an outer casing to improve its strength.

露西：你有办法吗，维克多?
Lucy: What do you think, Victor?

维克多：你问我？你能不能跟你那个“扑拉普死”科算中心的同事问问，想想办法?
Victor: Oh, now you're interested in my input? Sure, you don't want to ask someone else—maybe one of your nut-job colleagues?

露西：我们得自己解决。科算中心没有闲暇来处理这种问题。
Lucy: The LSCC does not have any staff to spare for this project. I am afraid you will have to do it.

她在这儿工作已经半年有余，听闻工程师正在捣鼓单人飞行的发明，机械女士便从她的游历中抽身出来，参与到了这一研究中。
It has been six months since she heard about the engineer's project—the development of a true powered wingsuit—and dropped everything to join it.

露西：储油罐的容量太少了，续航是个麻烦。
Lucy: This fuel tank will be too small for a flight of any significant duration.

露西：材料强度的上限约束了我们在动力系统上的改进空间。
Lucy: Not that it matters. Our engine is already severely limited by our materials and weight requirements.

露西：不过目前这个方案值得一试，如果能比上次的滞空时间更长，这就是有价值的。
Lucy: But we can still give it a try. Our current improvements should meaningfully increase our flight time.

机械女士转向墙板，扯下几张废稿。她至少慢慢看清了走出森林迷雾的那条路之所在。
The mechanical woman turns to the wall and unpins several unneeded drafts.

维克多：每次多个一秒、两秒有什么意义?
Victor: Meaningful? I doubt we'll manage more than a few extra seconds.

维克多：公司不会为这几秒钟的成果就投给我们大把大把的钞票。
Victor: They're expecting results. Real results. They aren't going to pay for a few seconds.

维克多：伙计，没有钱，这事儿就进行不下去！
Victor: If the company pulls out, we'll have to terminate the project.

维克多：该死的，他们付钱越来越迟了，最好别出什么麻烦……
Victor: And they've been delaying pay day a little more each month. Think they're trying to tell us something?

露西：没你想的那么难，我们还能继续。
Lucy: We have made progress. Our situation is not as grim as you make it out to be.

露西：你打算放弃了吗?
Lucy: Are you going to give up?

维克多：放弃？不！怎么可能！
Victor: Give up? No way!

维克多：你知道我为这事儿花了多少钱吗？该死的，我就不该被老屋里那堆废纸迷住。
Victor: Do you know how much I've spent on this project already? Now, if I were smart, I would've never taken up this crazy scheme in the first place.

露西：在你之前也有人做过尝试，维克多。
Lucy: There have been attempts before, Victor.

维克多：你以为我不知道？哈，一个有翼的飞人传说，消失在大西洋海岸！
Victor: Yeah, I know. I remember the stories from when I was a kid. Granny flew like a bird over from Europe. Well, maybe she did figure it out, but she didn't think to write it down before she croaked.

维克多：他们有谁成功了吗？没有，一个也没有！一个也**的没有！
Victor: And there have been plenty of others that have tried since! Did even one of them succeed? No! Not a single goddamn one!

维克多：哈！我维克多恐怕要成为最后一个设计这鬼东西的人了！
Victor: So, here I am, about to be the latest one to make the same damn fool mistakes. Maybe the last.

在不需要自知之明的地方，维克多先生却有着某种多余的自知之明。
A moment of bitter clarity strikes the engineer.

露西：最后一个？当然不是。
Lucy: The last one? Of course not.

露西：在你之前有过，在你之后当然还会有。有什么问题吗？
Lucy: Why would you think that? The dream of flight—no, I cannot imagine humanity ever giving up on it.

露西：这种无意义的争吵已经浪费了我们三个小时又四十八分钟十九秒的时间——从这个月一号直到刚才。
Lucy: Are you aware this pointless debate has cumulatively wasted 3 hours 48 minutes and 19 seconds of our time—just this month?

露西：该去把机翼拆下来再检查一次了，维克多。
Lucy: Time you might have spent better on checking these wings.

维克多：少对我发号施令，铁块头。
Victor: Don't tell me what to do, Iron Head.

不耐烦的工程师骂骂咧咧地走开，但依然照着她的指令回到了自己的工作中。
The engineer walks away, muttering unclear but targeted complaints, until he pivots and returns back to the wings.

露西：高温燃气持续通过管道时太危险了，我担心金属管撑不住这么剧烈的温度变化。
Lucy: Returning to my original query. I am concerned that heat from the exhaust will compromise the integrity of this piping.

维克多：别烦我，你给它浇点水，让它冷静冷静。
Victor: Why not cool it down with water or something?

露西：管道会爆裂的，先生。
Lucy: A rapid shift in temperature would cause the pipe to explode.

露西：尽管降温是下一阶段才需要考虑的问题，但长远考虑，最好试试别的材料。
Lucy: I admit that it is unlikely that this would occur during the course of our current maximum flight time.

露西：机翼发动的续航时间太短了，在燃料耗尽前，暂时还不会达到材料强度的上限。
Lucy: However, I suggest a change of material to avoid potential issues as we extend its duration.

维克多：别跟我说这些！必须用这个！
Victor: That's not an option. We've only got what we've got.

露西：为什么要按照这个低效的方案来？
Lucy: Why? We could greatly increase our efficiency, not to mention safety.

维克多：因为要满足他们的需求，必须为了今后能在他们的工厂量产做准备。
Victor: Because our investors asked us to! They want a model for mass production.

维克多：要紧的是别让公司对我们失望，否则公司就会撤资。
Victor: Our top priority is to give them confidence, otherwise they will cut our funding.

撤资。一想到这个词，维克多便面露苦色，几近狂躁。
"Cut our funding"—a threat that's looming ever nearer.

维克多： 俄亥俄人的大家伙比我们的进度快太多了，再折腾下去，我们会失去最好的时机……
Victor: Do you know how long those Wright boys are keeping their contraption in the air now? We're losing our only opportunity to make something of this project.

露西： 最好的时机?
Lucy: The only opportunity?

露西： 这是不正确的，维克多。
Lucy: That is not true, Victor.

露西： 在以百年计的尺度看来，三五年的差距微乎其微。
Lucy: Even if they were three to five years ahead of us, it would make no difference. We are heirs to the work of centuries.

露西： 更何况，我们也不完全是在同一条跑道上竞赛。
Lucy: Besides, we are not precisely direct competitors.

露西： 这是两条完全不同的道路，我不明白你的焦虑。
Lucy: They have produced a rigid-wing aircraft, not a single-person wingsuit. There is room for both concepts.

维克多： 一百年？三五年？我有几个三五年？如果他们赶在我们前头吸引了公众……
Victor: Centuries?! Three to five years ahead of us?! How many three to five years are there before I'm dead and gone?

维克多： 谁还会关心第二名和之后的选手？伙计，赢家所得应有尽有，其余的一无所有！一无所有！
Victor: You're wrong, Luce. If they bring that thing of theirs to the market first, they win. In this business, winner takes all, pal! And loser gets nothing, literally nothing!

露西： 这些成果不会被废弃。只要时间足够，第二名早晚也会跑过终点线。
Lucy: Even if we are not commercially successful, our work will not be meaningless, as long as we advance scientific knowledge.

维克多： 是的，跑过……跑过一条无人在意的终点，没有奖金，也没有荣誉和聚光灯，还有什么意义?
Victor: Yeah, maybe that's enough for your egghead pals at LSCC! But there's no glory in second place, Luce. No fame. No money. Not a red cent!

他为竞争对手的成功而焦虑，那股煎心的急躁让工程师鼓起青筋，气得几乎暴跳起来。
He seizes up, as if his rage is bubbling up under his skin, ready to explode.

露西： 冷静下来，维克多。
Lucy: Calm yourself, Victor.

露西： 去准备车，两个钟头后我们到停车场准备试飞。
Lucy: Go get the car. We will have a test flight at the parking lot in two hours.

维克多： 别指挥我。
Victor: Didn't I already tell you not to bark orders at me?

维克多： 好吧，刚才我话说重了，抱歉。别在意，我就是这么个脾气。
Victor: Sorry, Ms. Lucy. I'm just frustrated. I'm on a short fuse these days.

露西： 控制你的情绪，然后专注工作，维克多。
Lucy: We should focus on our work, Victor.

……

...

一通久等的电话，来自一个并不陌生的声音。
The telephone rings.

维克多转身跑向座机，却不慎踩在渗漏地面的机油上，狠狠摔了个痛。他爬向电话，抬手接起。
Victor runs toward the phone, slipping over the slick oil. He's half-cursing as he picks up the receiver.

维克多：对，对，您好，这是波士顿的维克多工作室，您需要——
Victor: Dammit—yes, hi, hello, yeah, this is Victor speaking. How can I—

公司代理人：维克多先生，基于近期形势的一些变化，我们非常遗憾地通知您……
Investor: Mr. Victor, we deeply regret that we must speak to you, due to some recent developments with our competitors.

公司代理人：对您和露西女士主持设计的挂载式单人飞行翼工程，经评估，我们认为这个项目不再适合投入后续资源。
Investor: We've been forced to reassess your project, and we've come to the conclusion that it is no-longer economical for us to maintain our involvement.

维克多：不再适合投入？你把话说明白点。
Victor: "Economical"? What do you mean?

公司代理人：简而言之，维克多先生，您将不再能像此前数月那样从我司得到资金和能源支持。
Investor: Simply put, we will be no longer providing any further funding or material support.

公司代理人：我们看不到这个项目的未来。就目前来说，我们认为威尔伯和奥维尔先生发明的成果是一个更值得关注的领域。
Investor: Given the growing success of your competitors and your own lack of results, it appears there is no longer a viable future for this project.

公司代理人：祝您一切顺利，希望将来还有与您共事的机会。
Investor: We appreciate your understanding in all of this. You will be hearing from us if we require your services in the future.

维克多：嘿！你**先别挂！怎么回事！
Victor: Hey! Don't hang up! What the hell are you saying?!

维克多：喂，喂——
Victor: Hey! Hey!

维克多：狗东西。
Victor: Bastards.

露西：发生什么事了？
Lucy: What is happening?

维克多：好消息和坏消息都有，你想先听哪一个？
Victor: Got good news, and bad. Which one do you want to hear first?

露西：你脸色不好。先把好消息告诉我。
Lucy: You look pale. Tell me the good news first.

维克多：好消息：我们不用根据公司的需求做设计了，那些指手画脚的外行人不会再来瞎指挥了。
Victor: The good news is we don't have to listen to those ignoramuses we called investors anymore.

维克多：坏消息：和瞎指挥的外行佬一起离开的，还有我们需要的钱。
Victor: The bad news is they're out.

露西：嗯，也就是说这个项目被公司放弃了？
Lucy: I see. So, they have abandoned the project?

维克多：嗯哼，你要这么理解也没错。
Victor: In a manner of speaking.

露西：——但还没有被我们放弃。
Lucy: But we have not abandoned it.

维克多：……
Victor: ...

工程师垂手坐在他那张油黑的座椅上，呼吸沉重，低垂着头。
The engineer sits down on the oily stool, head in palms, inadvertently smearing oil over his hair.

维克多：我可以联系一些老朋友，他们或许会感兴趣，愿意接手。
Victor: I've got some friends to call. They might be able to salvage this mess.

露西：很好，休息一下，然后继续工作。你需要咖啡吗？
Lucy: In the meantime, perhaps we should take a break. Would you like some coffee?

维克多：……我打算回家，回佛罗里达。
Victor: What? Coffee, nah ... thanks, Luce. But I'm not taking a break, this is it. It's over.

露西：嗯？
Lucy: Oh?

维克多：也许这从一开始就是个不可能实现的幻想。人怎么可能像鸟一样飞起来？
Victor: It was a fool's dream, Luce. Leave the flying to the birds and those damned Wright Brothers.

维克多：把这些破铜烂铁打包卖掉，好歹能回点本钱。
Victor: I'm talking about selling off all this junk. We might cover a part of our losses still.

露西：你失去信心了？
Lucy: Are you that easily defeated?

露西：剩下的耗材还足够再进行一次实验。
Lucy: We still have sufficient materials to improve on our current design.

维克多：实验，实验，无穷无尽的实验……还要失败多少次？
Victor: Oh, sure, and what about the one after that? Experiment after experiment, how many more times do I gotta fail before I wise up?

维克多：成功了又怎么样？迟来的成功和失败有什么区别？
Victor: And what's the use? Even if we could do it, we're already too late.

露西：去联系车，把东西带到海边——
Lucy: Come on, go get the car. We can run the experiment on the beach.

露西：不，带到查尔斯河河边。
Lucy: No, actually, we should go to the Charles River.

维克多：……你想做什么？
Victor: What are you up to?

露西：这个季节的河风更温和。
Lucy: The wind coming off the river will be steadier.

工程师在动摇，仿佛迎风吹展的白帆，时而左顾，时而右盼，进退无主。
He moves to get up, but sinks down. Unsure of his next move, looking like a ship tossing in a storm.

维克多：……
Victor: ...

维克多：你想最后再尝试一次吗？
Victor: One last run then? For old time's sakes?

露西： 这不会是最后一次。
Lucy: It will not be our last.

维克多： 如果能引起曝光和关注……嗯……的确，也许还有转机，河岸边人更多一些。
Victor: Hmm, yeah. Let's hope. Anyway, you're right. The river is best. We'll have more attention there. Provided we get off the ground.

露西： 这是正确的方向，在穷极所有的可能性之前，匆忙放弃并不明智。
Lucy: This is the right decision. It would be irresponsible to give up before attempting all other possibilities.

不明智的放弃，不明智的半途而废。半个多世纪前的记忆片段在机械女士脑海中重现。
She would not give up again. Her words conjure up an old memory—a friend from years ago in the distant past,

过去，这条路曾因恐惧和愚昧而被旅人放弃，犹如面对黎明前那叫人望而止步的黑暗，旅人转身离去。
of the last time she had shared this path with someone, and how superstition and fear had taken it away from them, just before they reached their dreams.

如今阻碍它的，则是令人遗憾的短视，是在驱动时代狂奔的机油味和纷飞的纸钞面前被熏得迷了魂的贪婪利欲。
And their obstacles here are far less significant. The only thing that stands in her partner's way now is his own ego and greed.

露西： 实际上，比起我刚来的时候，这个项目已经取得了很大进步。
Lucy: Just think back on how much progress we have made.

维克多： 行，那还是照计划来。你来飞，伙计，我不会游泳，你知道的……
Victor: Alright. We'll stick to the plan. But if we're taking the river, you'll have to fly. I can't swim.

露西： 没问题。
Lucy: Not a problem.

维克多： 就这么办！我去联系车和记者朋友。
Victor: Great! I'll get the car and call the reporters.

维克多： 但愿我们能在明早的报纸上抢到一个精彩版面……
Victor: Let's hope we get the headline tomorrow.

# “杂技表演”
## "Air Farce" CH19601-05

“杂技表演”
"Air Farce"

1908，查尔斯河河畔
Charles River Bank, 1908

河岸旁，游人三两成群，近半个世纪的繁荣与和平塑造了对新世纪的美好愿景。
It's a beautiful day, and many people have gathered along the river to enjoy it. The spirit of this moment in time feels intensely hopeful.

先是黑夜，再是蓝天，接着还将征服天空更远的天外——人们如此笃信，未来必将远胜当今。
Humans have conquered darkness with electric light and distance with the chug of locomotives. What will come next? Will they conquer the sky and beyond? If nothing else, they feel assured the future is bright.

维克多：嘿，朋友们，让让，烦请让让——
Victor: Ladies and gentlemen, make way please!

维克多：聚光灯准备好了吗？我会付钱的，杰克，会的，就这一次！你信我！
Victor: Are the spotlights ready? I'll pay, Sam! Trust me, for once!

维克多：谢谢，先生，就一小会儿，我保证，最迟半个钟头，绝不影响您工作！
Victor: Thank you, sir. This won't take long, I promise. 30 minutes tops, and I'll be out of your way!

工程师忙着在河畔广场给自己抢出一块空地，跟他不耐烦的记者朋友们一一赔笑，同时紧张布置着场地。
Victor has become one-part engineer and two-parts showman, frantically lining up equipment and impatient reporters at the same time.

维克多：我跟你保证，接下来你将拍下本世纪最了不起的几张照片，别说《纽约太阳报》了，就是——
Victor: I promise you, gentlemen, soon you will possess the most memorable and valuable photos of the century. Forget the headlines of The Sun, this is history—

维克多：好好好，我去跟我的助手聊聊，她马上就来，马上就来！
Victor: Ah, pardon me. I need a moment to talk with my lovely assistant.

工程师敛起他硬邦邦的假笑，一边擦汗，一边跑向机械女士，搬运下沉重的金属架。
The engineer wipes off his fake smile as quickly as he turns, running over to help Lucy unload the metal frame.

露西：我会尽快把设备组装好，不会超过五分钟。
Lucy: The assembly time should be approximately five minutes.

维克多：……我有个办法，露西。
Victor: Yeah, yeah, great—I just got a brilliant idea, Luce.

露西：嗯，说。
Lucy: I am listening.

维克多：我们承受不起失败，你明白的……
Victor: We both know we can't afford another failure.

工程师压低声音，左右环视，悄悄给出自己的“建议”。
The engineer glances around and hushes his voice.

维克多：用一下你的神秘术，真的，有几个地方我还是不放心，最好还是……
Victor: Our current model still has some problems to be solved, so why don't you just use that arcane skill of yours to "spruce her up," you know?

露西：你的意思是，要我使用神秘术改变机械结构，从而保证这次实验的成功?
Lucy: You mean you want me to change its mechanical structure to make the experiment work?

维克多：对对对对对，就、就是这个意思……！
Victor: Yes, yes! E-exactly what I mean!

露西：不，我拒绝这个提议。
Lucy: No. I refuse.

维克多：啊？为什么？你怎么——
Victor: What? Why? What's ...

露西：神秘术的时效有限，而且存在失败的风险。
Lucy: First, you must remember there are limits to my arcane skill. I may run out of time, and it is possible it will not work.

维克多：我们本来就没什么胜算！再往赌桌上扔两块筹码又怎么样！
Victor: The odds are already stacked against us in the first place! What could it hurt, even if it fails?

露西：维克多，我不可能对将来生产的每一台设备都施加神秘术。
Lucy: It would be impossible for me to enchant every suit once our model is put into mass production.

露西：也不可能在每一个使用它的人起飞前都为他们施加神秘术。
Lucy: Without even mentioning that it would be impossible to enchant them each time they were needed.

露西：这不是一条可行之道。
Lucy: Arcane skills simply do not work that way.

露西：如果接下来要进行大规模生产，那必须基于稳定、可控、可复制的方案。
Lucy: Our goal is a stable, reliable, and practical model. Who would buy anything less?

机械女士比她的伙伴看得更远，因为工程师并非马戏团的杂耍艺人或兜售神秘学小玩意儿的江湖术士。
She focuses on the future, not the present, hoping to appeal to the engineer's true desire.

露西：所以我拒绝这个提议。去把机翼搬下来，该把它们组装起来了。
Lucy: Now, you have my reasons. Please assist me with the wings.

维克多：噢，你在想什么？如果今天不能成功，这事儿就没有以后了！
Victor: Do you have that head of yours screwed on wrong? Or do you really not get that our project is done if we fail again?!

维克多：伙计！你听我的，对燃气机动动手，让记者们拍下你在天上打招呼的漂亮样子！
Victor: Luce, it's real simple: enchant the engine, go up and have a little fun in the sky, then come back down to greet the reporters when they come to take photos of you!

维克多：公司会回心转意，然后求着我们继续这个项目，到时候我们愿意要多少，他们就会给多少！
Victor: Our investors will change their minds. Hell, they'll beg us to continue. Then we'll have all the money we could ever want to make this hunk of bolts really work!

维克多：一千、一万、十万美元……那些钞票叠起来比你我加起来还高！
Victor: And once we actually finish it, Luce, buddy, we'll have stacks as high as Rockefeller.

露西：嗯，所以你要一堆叠起来三米多高的纸做什么？
Lucy: OK. But why would we want a pile of paper?

维克多：……
Victor: ...

维克多：不为这个，我为什么要偷走老屋里的那堆写满潦草笔记的旧纸稿，千里迢迢跑波士顿来搞实验？
Victor: That's all I've ever wanted! Ever since I found these old drafts while cleaning up my old nan's house.

露西：我不关心你的动机，维克多。
Lucy: Your motivations notwithstanding.

露西：我在乎的是这个项目很有前景，仅此而已。
Lucy: This project has a promising future. That is all I know.

维克多扔下攥在手中的稿纸，露西将这些不受主人待见的梦想一一捡起，放回车上。
Victor throws the drafts to the ground in a huff. Lucy picks them up and returns them to the car.

露西：它们还有用处。
Lucy: We still need these.

维克多：哼，但愿如此。
Victor: Like hell we do!

工程师气冲冲地转身离开，转眼间，那露骨的假笑又挤上脸庞，朝向众人。
The engineer storms away, but as he enters sight of the crowd, he puts on his fake smile as cool as he can be.

寥寥无几的“众人”。
It's smaller than he'd hoped.

露西：维克多，把人群疏散。
Lucy: Victor, please ask the crowd to disperse.

露西：我不想发生意外的时候伤到路人。
Lucy: There may be unexpected dangers. I do not want anyone to be hurt.

维克多：烦请诸位让让，我的助手十分体贴而谨慎，尽管这个发明堪称完美，绝无意外可能……
Victor: You heard the lady, folks. My assistant is meticulously careful and considerate. Even though our invention is completely safe.

维克多：但本着人道主义和科学精神，她依然考虑到了最最极端的、几乎不可能发生的情况。
Victor: Still, as a practical humanist and a thorough scientist, she's always taking even the rarest and most extreme worst-case scenarios into consideration. But I do really have to emphasize "rarest."

维克多：接下来请诸位见证维克多工作室的杰作：单人挂载式飞行翼，只需要操纵摇杆，按下按钮，您就能畅享翱翔天空的乐趣！
Victor: Now, ladies and gentlemen, let's witness the latest creation of Victor's Workshop: the fantastic wingsuit! Press one button and control the wings with a simple lever. That's all it takes to fly right up into the sky!

露西：再等等，维克多，现在不是时候。
Lucy: Hold on, Victor. We are not quite ready.

露西：风向很乱，不能在这时候起飞。
Lucy: There is some turbulence in the air. We should delay for a short while until it passes.

维克多：……
Victor: ...

维克多：请诸位原谅，恐怕我们需要再对设备进行一次最终调试，为保证展出效果，请再耐心等待短短的两分钟。
Victor: Excuse us, friends. I'm afraid we need to adjust our equipment just one last time to make sure it all runs smoothly. Please, give us just two more minutes!

围观游人：你们是哪个马戏团来的?
The Crowd: Hey, what circus are you from, pal?

维克多：波士顿的维克多工作室，先生，绝非魔术马戏，也并非神秘学家的小把戏。
Victor: Victor's Workshop of Boston, sir. We're not a circus or some arcane swindlers.

围观游人：一个机器人？一个装在机器人背上的机器翅膀？哈哈！
The Crowd: A pair of iron wings? Installed on a robot's back? Sure sounds like a clown act to me! Haha!

围观游人：我倒想瞧瞧这里头有些什么门道。
The Crowd: Go on, let's see it then! What can she do?

维克多：我们不能等太久，伙计，大家已经不耐烦了！
Victor: We can't keep waiting, Luce. The crowd's turning on us.

露西：等到风向有利。
Lucy: I am on standby until the right wind arrives.

露西：你为什么着急？
Lucy: You appear anxious. Why is that?

风吹过河面。
游船上，无所事事的居民聚在船舷边，远远看向岸上的两人。
A ship floats past them on the river, its passengers gawking at the scene.

维克多：再等下去，别说路人了，连记者都会撤走！
Victor: Because, we need to take off now. Or all those very nice folk out there are going to leave, and our last chance for fame and fortune goes with them.

露西：是吗？这会给项目研究带来什么麻烦？
Lucy: Is that so? What does that mean for the project?

露西：聚光灯对飞行有什么益处？
Lucy: What good does that spotlight do for our experiment?

露西：站在河岸边的游人的目光是否能改良机械结构？
Lucy: Will the people gathering by the river help us optimize our wingspan, our power source?

维克多：……如果没有观众，那今天做的这一切有什么意义？
Victor: You're being difficult. What's the point of this experiment if no one is here to see it?

露西：我们会用一次精彩的试飞来验证近期的研究成果。
Lucy: The point? The point is that we put our work into perfecting this machine. Is that not point enough?

露西：即便失败，也能从中找到改进的道路。我不认为这是个悲观的梦想。
Lucy: Even if something does go wrong, it will give us a chance to analyze and fix it. That is the point.

露西：从第一盏风筝发明以来，人类就憧憬着乘风飞起。
Lucy: Humans have dreamed of flying in the wind since before even the first kite flew into the air.

露西：而近些年人类在材料科学和内燃机领域取得的硕果，则使梦想成为了初步具有可行性的现实方案。
Lucy: And now, our achievements in materials science and the development of the internal combustion engine have laid the foundation for us to make this dream a reality.

露西：维克多，一次失败会怎么样呢？你已经失败了上百次，这不过是给分母数字再加一个最小正整数而已。
Lucy: What do we lose even if we fail again, Victor? We have failed a hundred times. What is so terrible about one more?

焦躁的工程师无言以对。西风拂过河岸，向缅因湾的湛蓝海水奔去。
The engineer has no answer for her. The moment turns as a swift westerly wind blows across the river bank.

维克多：起风了，伙计！
Victor: That's your wind, Luce! Go on!

维克多：动起来，快，动起来——
Victor: Move! Move! Good luck!

露西：祝我们顺利。
Lucy: It is in the hands of fate now.

机械女士将飞行翼装上自己的暗银色手臂。
The mechanical woman pulls the device over her silvery arms.

银翼的飞鸟走到岸边，启动按钮，滚烫蒸汽自灼热的排热管道涌出——而非出自她那伟大的活塞核心。
Now a bird with iron wings, she walks to the edge of the river bank and presses a button as a jet of air erupts beneath her.

神秘术缄默不语，在此发出轰鸣的乃是基于人类科学而完成的金属飞翼。
No signs of arcanum, only the mechanical rumble of human technology.

露西：我感觉这比之前任何一次都更好。
Lucy: We have done all we can. I have a feeling that this time we will succeed.

维克多：准备好了吗——
Victor: You ready?

维克多：各位，请看，请睁大双眼——
Victor: Ladies and gentlemen, please direct your eyes—

维克多：你们即将见证人类两千年来最伟大的一项发明！
Victor: For you are about to bear witness to the greatest invention in human history!

维克多：它将云海化为大地，叫天空成为无水之海，我们将能畅游其中！
Victor: Where Icarus failed, we succeed. Now, mankind will take to the skies just as easily as the birds.

如同七十年前那位向着大海奔跑飞起的女孩，机械女士展开银翼，向着查尔斯河一跃而下。
Like her friend ran toward the sea those many years ago, Lucy spreads her wings and leaps from the river bank.

围观游人：嘿，她跳了！
The Crowd: Hey! That was a jump! She jumped!

围观游人：她真的能飞起来吗？就靠那鸟翅膀玩意儿？
The Crowd: Come on, do any of you think that stupid contraption is going to fly?

没有好事之徒期盼的落水声。水鸟振翅而起，被燃气驱动的爆鸣声惊飞。
Where many expected a splash, they hear instead a roar, as the engine pulls her up and over the surface of the water.

露西：……比我预想中糟糕。
Lucy: There appears to be some unexpected instability.

维克多：看，看，她从河堤下面起来了！正是如此！
Victor: Look, look! She's rising, folks! That's no mere glide! But 100% genuine powered flight!

维克多：飞啊，飞！
Victor: Up, and onwards!

工程师额边汗珠不断。他紧握双手，屏住呼吸，目光跟随着银翼的飞鸟掠过河面。
The engineer stares out at the silvery bird as it holds just above the river's surface.

攥在手中的麻黄色设计稿纸被汗水浸湿，几乎揉作一卷。
Sweat drips off his forehead, and the yellow draft paper in his hand is now a crumpled ball. But he turns back to the crowd.

露西：维克多——
Lucy: Victor—

维克多：安全、稳定、可靠，只需要简单阅读我们的使用手册，就是八岁小孩也能熟练掌握这一机械的驾驶方法。
Victor: Let me tell you folks. This thing is safe, stable, and reliable. Why even a child may pilot it after a few short lessons!

维克多： 它比飞机更廉价，比火车更轻巧，比轮船更便捷——
Victor: Imagine it, faster than an airship, more convenient than a locomotive, and cheaper than an automobile!

露西： 维克多！
Lucy: Victor!

维克多： 只需要投入小小的一笔资金，我保证，不出一年，这笔投资将带给您难以想象的丰厚回报！
Victor: Gentlemen, I ask you now for just a small investment. One small payment, to put yourself in front of the most important invention of our time!

维克多： 有什么比这更好的机会呢？现在，就是现在，财富与光荣正向你我招手，正如这高高飞起的梦想——
Victor: This is a once-in-a-lifetime opportunity to own a piece of the future! Seize it now! Fame and fortune await!

露西： 燃油快耗尽了，维克多。
Lucy: Victor! Something is wrong!

蒸汽从河岸上消失了，淡如正午的雾，在风中迅速消散。
The engine begins to sputter and cough, no longer moving forward. The buffeting wind pulls her into a tumble.

……

...

围观游人： 你的梦想摔下去了，伙计。
The Crowd: Your future just took a nose dive, pal.

围观游人： 嘿，她落水了。
The Crowd: Oof, look how she hit the water! That could've killed somebody!

维克多： ——！
Victor: ...!

工程师目瞪口呆，为查尔斯河溅起的水花惊得说不出话来。
The engineer turns white, slowly wrenching his head toward the splash.

维克多： 不！
Victor: No!

维克多： 不……
Victor: No ...

落水的飞鸟卸掉双翼，从水中浮起，游回岸边。
The iron bird pulls herself up to the river bank and drops her wings.

露西： 我想我知道问题在哪了。
Lucy: I believe that I have found our problem.

露西： 现有的发动机根本不能支持如此巨大的能耗，风和燃油提供的动力都不够。
Lucy: Our engine is not providing sufficient downward thrust to keep us in the air, even with the aid of wind.

露西： 维克多，这套强行拼凑连接的核心系统没有意义，这只会加快燃料消耗。
Lucy: There are also many extraneous parts. We could significantly streamline the design to improve our fuel efficiency.

露西： 真正需要的是改进效率，提高输出功率。
Lucy: If we can improve the overall power output—

维克多： 是吗？那你去折腾吧。无所谓了，伙计，祝你好运。
Victor: Yeah, well, good luck with that, Luce. I'm out.

维克多： 没人会往这个项目投钱，一分钱也不会投。
Victor: No one is going to invest after today—Not a penny.

维克多： 这**就是个愚蠢的赔本生意！十年！二十年！五十年都回不了本！我的钱……！
Victor: It's a money pit, and I'm tired of digging it. No chance I'm going to see a profit, not in ten years, not in a hundred!

机械女士擦去金属身躯上的水珠，走回岸边，走向散去的人群，捡起那摞被主人遗弃的设计稿。
The mechanical woman dries herself and walks to the engineer as he mopes on the ground.

它们不该被如此抛弃。
They deserve a better ending.

露西： 你要和希梅娜一样，走到半路就离开吗?
Lucy: So, you give up? We got this close, and you just want to walk away?

维克多： 就这样吧。
Victor: Seems like it, don't it?

维克多用一声叹息为自己短暂的尝试画上句号。
他压低帽檐，转身消失在河畔人潮中，为自己的失败落荒而逃。
Victor ends his last attempt with a heaving sigh. Pulling his hat down over his face, he walks out into the crowd and doesn't return.

露西： 这和之前的每一次失败没什么不同。
Lucy: This is only another failed result.

露西： 我们已经找到了改进的方向。
Lucy: We have found another avenue for improvement.

露西： 这不过是一个小小的挫折，一段弯路，一场不成功的展出。
Lucy: This is nothing more than a minor setback. An unsuccessful experiment is not a critical failure.

一个望向天空的梦想，却受挫于脚边的几张纸钞。
The crowd is dispersing now, and Victor has disappeared with them. Flying is a beautiful dream, but dreams do nothing for a man with an empty wallet and a growling stomach.

露西： ……
Lucy: ...

露西： 你看到的只有自己伸手就能握住的东西，维克多。
Lucy: You only ever saw what you could reach in one grasp, Victor.

露西： 比起人类来说，天空或许更有耐心。
Lucy: But it takes more patience than that if you really want to touch the sky.

她紧握住那一张张散落的梦想，将其整理归档，拖拽着落水的飞翼，沉默地回到自己的命运中。
But he is gone; the random movement of fate has left her alone once more.

但她不会停下脚步，永远不会。
But that will not stop her.

露西： 他走到半路，就像面对马特洪峰的旅人，被眼前的高山和苦厄吓坏了，于是转身离去。
Lucy: Like many before him, he was terrified by the difficulties ahead and changed his course, like those mountaineers who turned from the Matterhorn long before they reached its peak.

露西：但还有人——在他身后，还会有很多人向着高山飞去。
Lucy: But I know there will be others—those behind him—that will climb higher than he had ever imagined.

# 天穹有翼
## Inherited Wings CH19601-06

天穹有翼
Inherited Wings

1969，佛罗里达办事处
Floridian Branch of Space Center, 1969

职员：露西女士，很感谢您两年来在航天中心的服务。
Space Center Employee: On behalf of the Space Center, we really wanted to thank you for your service these past years, Madam Lucy.

职员：休假安排在相关文件上已经做了详细说明，接下来请享受您的假期。佛罗里达海岸的阳光向来颇受游人欢迎。
Space Center Employee: I brought you a few brochures for you to look over with some great vacation spots. Sunny beaches, high-class resorts—you'll have lots of things to do.

机械女士接过纸质通知。于她而言，只要电力供应充足，休假或是工作，其实并无不同。
She accepts the offered papers gracefully, but there is no real joy in it for her. A holiday resort is no different to her from a quiet office with an adequate power supply.

职员：您可以在电视上观看月球登陆直播，直播时间请参考相关通知。
Space Center Employee: Oh, and I included the schedule for the moon landing broadcast. Didn't want you to miss it.

露西：请致电湾岸中学外联办公室，胡安娜女士接。
Lucy: Would you ring the Bay Shore High School for me? I need to talk to Ms. Joanna.

露西：她这时候该在办公室的。
Lucy: I am sure she will be in her office now.

职员：好、好的。
Space Center Employee: O-okay.

……

...

……

...

???：您好……
???: Hello.

露西：你好，胡安娜女士。我今天就到，最迟——
Lucy: Hello, Ms. Joanna. I am letting you know I will arrive later today, before ...

她抬眼看向挂钟，三根指针恰好连成直线。
She looks up at the clock.

露西：最迟日落之前。嗯，待会儿见。
Lucy: Shortly before dusk. Yes, see you later.

胡安娜：嗯，嗯，我在学校等你。
Joanna: Okay. I'll wait for you here.

她一向珍视时间，一向不愿为了琐事耽搁，将电话挂断得干净利落。
Lucy hangs up without another word. Never one for formalities.

露西： 我需要去湾岸镇的车。
Lucy: I will need a ride to Bay Shore.

职员： 好的。麻烦到基地第一公路旁的 K-388 车位等待，十五分钟后会有一趟专车在那儿等您。
Space Center Employee: Sure. I'll arrange for a car to pick you up outside the center.

露西： 要开多久?
Lucy: How long will it take to get there?

职员： 路况良好的话，不超过一个小时车程。
Space Center Employee: Less than an hour, if the traffic isn't too bad.

职员： 请放心，军方已经在基地附近实行了交通管制，您将一路畅通。
Space Center Employee: And that shouldn't be a worry. The military has arranged a cordon all around the center.

露西： 嗯，好，很高兴看到航天中心保持着它一贯的高效作风。
Lucy: Good. I am glad to see that the Space Center remains as efficient as ever.

露西： 预祝你们顺利，我十分期待看到登月舱抵达月球的历史性时刻。
Lucy: You have prepared for everything with more than adequate redundancies. I am looking forward to witnessing this historic moment.

露西： 噢，对了，还有我在卧室里的行李，那些储备电池和机械设备，全都需要装车带走。
Lucy: I will also need my luggage and equipment brought to the car before I leave. If that will not be too much trouble.

1969，湾岸中学
Bay Shore Middle School, 1969

她不擅长对付学生，因为这些少年少女的脑袋里总是装满天马行空的想法，难以理解。
Adolescents, even of the older variety, have always confused Lucy. The patterns of their behavior unpredictable and frequently irrational.

机械女士走进校园，人类后代便将她团团围住，好奇地上上下下摆弄她的金属身躯。
As she arrives, she is instantly reminded of that discomfort. The students begin flocking to her.

学生 I： 嘿，机器人！山姆、安妮，你们都来看看！哇喔！一个真正的机器人！
Student I: Woah, a robot! Hey Jack, Annie, come check it out! A real-live robot!

露西： 请让开——
Lucy: Please allow me through.

露西： 请——
Lucy: Please.

人类少年的身高在他们蓬勃旺盛的好奇心面前显得那么小，却令她无处挪步，让她被困在走廊，没法动弹。
The mechanical woman is surrounded by students, forming an impenetrable wall of questions.

???: 给客人让路。
???: Give her some space.

???: 你们这样不礼貌。
???: Is that how any of you would treat a guest?

露西： 噢，胡安娜。你看起来很健康，比从前更健康。
Lucy: Oh, Joanna. You look healthy. Have you improved your diet and exercise regime?

胡安娜：这就是你打招呼的方式吗？哈哈，你好像从人们那儿学到了些东西。
Joanna: Is that robot for: "good to see you?" Well, I'm glad you haven't changed too much from hanging around with all those brainiacs without me.

露西：健康的身体和灵活的大脑有助于更好地推进手中的工作。我也会定期检修自己。
Lucy: A healthy body and a clear mind will improve performance in humans. And even I need regular maintenance.

露西：确保性能良好，保证各部位装置妥善运行，以免在关键时刻丧失行动能力。
Lucy: Without it, I might experience unnecessary component failures—Or, sorry, I mean to say, it is good to see you, too.

胡安娜：好了，小飞行员们，你们一定很想去海边活动活动，把东西都搬过去——
Joanna: Alright then, as for all of you, I'm sure you are eager to hit the beach. Grab your things and get going.

胡安娜：我和这位客人还有事情要谈，待会儿咱们再见。去吧，别在这里拦住大家的路。
Joanna: I need a moment to speak to our guest. Off you go.

1969，胡安娜的办公室
Joanna's Office, 1969

胡安娜：这些是奖杯，我的学生抱回来的。带这些青春期小孩可一点不比在航天中心的工作轻松。
Joanna: These are their trophies. I know it's not as glamorous as working for the Space Center, but teaching has rewards of its own.

胡安娜女士颇为骄傲地将自己的成就指给昔日同事，这丝毫不逊色于她过去的成功。
The trophies are not inconsiderable, and by the reaction of her students, she has most certainly achieved her own kind of success.

露西：很高兴看到你有一份充实的退休生活。
Lucy: I am glad to see that you have found something meaningful to do after you left.

胡安娜：是吗？我反倒觉得能看到你像现在这样从茫茫多的事务里抽身出来休息，很让人高兴。
Joanna: And I'm happy to see you finally taking a break.

胡安娜：妥善维护有益于延长设备的使用寿命喔。
Joanna: I was beginning to think you'd be working until your wiring melted.

露西：只要供电稳定……噢，这里的电灯是接触不良吗？
Lucy: Hmm? As long as my power supply is stable, there should be no risk of damage to my wiring.

灯管不时闪烁，从踏进校门那一刻起，机械女士就注意到这儿似乎在有意识地控制能耗。
As if matching her statement, the lights begin to flicker in the building.

胡安娜：或许是发电机出了故障，别紧张。
Joanna: Probably just the generator. Don't worry your pretty metal head over it.

露西：噢，不！你们应该……
Lucy: Oh no! You should—

胡安娜：放松，露西，湾岸镇的人们已经习惯了这种生活，不会持续太久了。
Joanna: Relax, Lucy. We've all gotten used to it.

胡安娜：这附近的维护团队都被抽调到航天中心待命了。
Joanna: That Space Center of yours is a bit of a power suck. But a few flickering bulbs aren't a bad price to pay for the moon.

胡安娜：我不想错过后天早晨的直播，万一供电系统出了问题……
Joanna: It shouldn't affect the broadcast. But we'll just have to hope the system can hold up until then.

胡安娜： 留点儿后手总是好事，对吧?
Joanna: But, that's why we always have a plan B, right?

露西： 我同意。考虑到最糟糕的情况，这些应急预案当然有它们的价值。
Lucy: Agreed. People underestimate their value. But in an emergency, redundancies always prove their worth.

露西： 但最好别让这些价值真正发挥功效。
Lucy: But best not to leave it to chance.

……

...

胡安娜： ……找到了。
Joanna: Found it.

胡安娜： 记得这个吗?
Joanna: Remember this?

机械女士摊开稿纸，这是胡安娜离开时她赠与的礼物——小小的、像人类一样代表着善意的礼物。
They unfold a tattered old draft. A gift for Joanna to celebrate her retirement. One of the few human rituals she has come to value.

露西： 这只是我参与过的众多项目之一，得益于近年来航空事业的进步，它的价值才被重新发现。
Lucy: I am happy that our modern advances in aviation have, at last, made this project viable.

露西： 当时我很忙，它在你手里会比放在我的储物柜里更有作用。
Lucy: But, with my other work, I have not had any time to work on it. I am glad you have been able to make use of it.

胡安娜： 不，是你一直在完善它。
Joanna: Ah, well I had the time you didn't, but you're the one that's really driven this project forward.

露西： 我只是记录并保存着它们，偶尔做一些尝试。
Lucy: Attending your experiments and record-keeping are far from significant contributions.

露西： 更何况我已经起码两年没关注这件事了。
Lucy: And it has been a long time since I have done even that.

露西： 进展如何?
Lucy: What is your current progress?

胡安娜： 不比你们这几年发射的火箭慢，哈哈，但也没你想象中那么厉害。
Joanna: Not as far as your rocket, for certain. But we're making real progress.

露西： 没关系，这只是个时间问题。或快或慢，只是非常简单的时间投入与产出效率的问题。
Lucy: Invention takes time. I cannot fault you for lacking the same resources I have access to at the Space Center.

露西： 不过最近十年我们在航空航天领域的进步快得不可思议，各方都在加大投入，这是好事。
Lucy: It is remarkable just how much progress we have made even in the last decade.

露西： 俄国研究人员在过去二十年的实践提供了很大帮助，他们已经验证了技术的可行性。
Lucy: And it has been an international effort, even despite our differences. It is remarkable how much we have learned from the Soviet Space Program.

胡安娜： 是呀……有人跑在前面，别的选手就会不甘心落后，于是奋起直追。
Joanna: The competition starts as soon as someone takes the lead.

胡安娜：拜科努尔发射场把第一颗卫星发射到了平流层外，所以我们也这么干。
Joanna: The Baikonur Cosmodrome sent the first satellite above the stratosphere, and we sent the second one.

胡安娜：后来，竞争对手又把火箭抛上宇宙，于是我们也不甘心，在佛罗里达研究中心紧跟着搞了自己的火箭。
Joanna: Then they launched a manned rocket into space. We had to catch up with them, so we made our own.

胡安娜：他们还想把手伸向月球、伸向火星和更远的天外星海。
Joanna: Now they're aiming at the moon, Mars, and maybe the galaxy is next.

胡安娜：但我们不会跟在他们屁股后面吃火箭尾焰了。
Joanna: But we're not going to be left watching their exhaust this time. Now we're going to take the lead.

她的笑容中似乎张扬着一种信心，一种对于竞胜争先的渴望。
A prideful smile stretches over her face.

露西：我很欣赏这种竞争意识。
Lucy: I appreciate your competitiveness.

露西：和对手一起跑，往往能让我们跑得更快。
Lucy: It makes us work faster, think smarter, run farther.

露西：如果后天下午他们能把人类的脚印落在月球上，胡安娜……
Lucy: Once we leave those first footsteps there, in the dust of another world,

露西：那接下来就会有更多——
Lucy: there is no telling how far humanity will run.

露西：新的足迹，新的探测器，新的宇航员，然后是小型定居点，第一批移民……航天中心已经有相关规划了。
Lucy: There will be new footprints, new detectors, new astronauts, new bases, and then settlers. The Space Center has made plans for all of it.

置身事外的女士似乎对此并不关心，而是回望着展示柜——那是她的学生得到的荣耀。
Her friend has turned back to the trophy case.

胡安娜：是啊，山姆和彼得也常常为谁的小飞机飞得更高、更久而较劲。
Joanna: Jack and Peter are always competing with each other. They've pushed themselves so hard, and each time they fly a little higher and a little longer than the last time.

胡安娜：这些奖杯里有一半是山姆的，而另一半则属于彼得。少了任何一个，他们中的另一个就会变得倦怠，躺在过去的荣誉上懒洋洋地发呆，停步不前。
Joanna: I think near half of these are Jack's, and most of the rest are Peter's. I doubt they'd have gotten this far if the other wasn't there to push them another step.

两个少年奋力争先，都渴望着摘下下一个哪怕是小得好似芥菜种子般的胜利，将之装扮上先前斩获的桂冠。
Their awards tell the story as well as she could, small incremental gains, iteration over iteration. But each victory was a badge of honor.

露西：嗯，所以呢？你的学生们有些什么成果？
Lucy: So, you have them working on the project too?

胡安娜：他们向往飞行，所以我拿着你给的设计，跟他们一起折腾。
Joanna: I brought them on board as soon as they showed interest. Their work is largely based on your designs.

胡安娜： 你提供的原型机对我们很有帮助，那比半个世纪前的飞行翼雏形改良了不少。
Joanna: That prototype you sent us served as an excellent model.

露西： 是吗？它几乎一直都被搁置着，胡安娜。
Lucy: Is that so? It had been shelved for a long time.

露西： 我没有特别对它们做什么，当曾经卡住研究的麻烦取得新的突破时，我就做一点改进，然后试试看。
Lucy: Every once in a while, I would take it out again, whenever I found a new technology or material that could be incorporated into the design.

露西： 这种实验品很少能达到预期效果，但总归在慢慢向前。
Lucy: It has been the work of decades, centuries almost. I am very glad to hear you have made progress on it.

胡安娜： 你没有放弃它们，露西。
Joanna: Only because you never gave up on it.

露西： 没有任何项目该被草率放弃，除非它们已被确证毫无价值。
Lucy: A project should not be idly abandoned, not until all avenues of success have been exhausted.

露西： 但这种情况不多。
Lucy: And that is a rare case.

露西： 准确来说，这种情况极少，极少极少，从概率层面几乎可以忽略。
Lucy: In fact, perhaps I am optimistic, but I think that such a case almost never happens.

露西： 而问题在于时间、资源和有限的精力，我没办法维护所有东西。
Lucy: The only real challenge is in what projects deserve our time and resources. There is no way to juggle everything. Sometimes other work must take precedent.

胡安娜： 只要记得它们，不要忘掉就好，未来总有人会再捡起那些被搁置的幻想——
Joanna: That's why we share these ideas. What was it you always said? "Like an ember passed from hand to hand?"

胡安娜： 来吧，露西，去看看你播下的小小的种子们——
Joanna: C'mon, Lucy. Let me show you what we've done with that ember.

一个无心之举。
*It was an uplifting invitation.*

胡安娜： 两年过去，它已经萌芽、茁壮，开出小小的花蕾了。但那只是个业余项目，没什么商业价值，是孩子们的玩具。
Joanna: After two years, we're finally seeing the sparks take flame. Though it isn't much now. Just something for them to play around with.

露西： 我不记得在这里进行过植物培植相关的研究。也许是我忘了。
Lucy: You mean, you have actually made something of my designs?

露西： 有什么种子需要种下去，还得再等两年时间才会开始生长？
Lucy: How did you overcome the issues with fuel capacity?

露西： 或许你们该检查一下温室环境的各项参数，比如保温和透光性能。需要我帮忙吗？
Lucy: Were you able to find a rigid material capable of withstanding the drag force? One that is still flexible enough to allow the pilot to pivot in the air?

几颗种在孩子们心里的，被写在纸上、曾被它们短视的主人抛弃的种子。
*How long had she kept that ember? How many before them had thrown it away? But now, it seems that it is burning once more.*

胡安娜： ……

Joanna: ...

胡安娜： 哈哈哈哈哈！

Joanna: Ha-ha-ha-ha!

胡安娜： 跟我去看看吧！佛罗里达的雏鸟们都很想飞得更高些呢——

Joanna: Oh, Lucy, I'm sure you have a million questions. But let's just go see our pilots in action.

# 雏鸟们

## The Fledglings CH19601-07

雏鸟们

The Fledglings

1969，湾岸镇海滩

Beach, Bay Shore Town, 1969

飞鸟成群掠过海面，鸣叫着飞往西方。海浪一如千百年来那般冲洗着沙岸。

Birds swoop out over the water, flying east over the crashing waves.

胡安娜： 有些好事的记者为佛罗里达编造了不少故事。

Joanna: You know, the papers love writing crazy headlines about Florida.

胡安娜： 失踪二十年的幽灵船神秘飘回了东海岸，迷失多年的飞机自大洋海底飞出，长翅膀的飞人宣称自己被外星人掳走……

Joanna: Like "Ghost Ship Returns from the Atlantic," "Lost War Plane Guided Home by Little Green Men," "Winged Man Lands on Tampa Beach" ...

露西： 航天中心的同事聊起过这些传闻——

Lucy: I have heard them before. Our colleagues sometimes share their favorites over lunch.

露西： 一边嚼早餐玉米片，一边笑得拍桌。

Lucy: They would laugh so hard they spilled their coffee.

露西： 把餐桌弄得一团糟，这不是件好事。

Lucy: It was always a mess afterward.

胡安娜： ……从这片海岸往南，穿过巴哈马与波多黎各，再折向北边，与百慕大群岛形成三角区域，就在这片漂亮的海域。

Joanna: They say it's the "Devil's Triangle" three points between our coast, Puerto Rico, and Bermuda.

露西： 我不相信。

Lucy: I never considered them credible.

露西： 未经验证的报道中往往存在大量误导，应该筛选出事实，而不是盲信传言。

Lucy: The waters in this so-called triangle are no more treacherous or magical than any other. People should be careful about separating truth from superstition.

露西： 我不觉得你会相信这些。

Lucy: I do not doubt that you are more than capable of that.

胡安娜： 我只相信最后一个。我是说……我想去相信最后一个，万一它是真的呢?

Joanna: Of course I can, but, I mean, that last story, I guess I want it to be true. What if it is?

露西： 嗯，也就是说你认为会有长翅膀的人类从大西洋西部海域出现，并降落在佛罗里达海岸。

Lucy: I see. So, you believe that a winged human appeared from the Atlantic and landed here?

胡安娜：当你把维克多叔公丢掉的设计稿交给我的时候，我还很惊讶……
Joanna: Well, it's just that after you gave me that draft from Uncle Victor.

胡安娜：但后来觉得，这可能是一种冥冥中的天意。
Joanna: At first, I thought we'd never get any further than he did, but when I saw that, I thought maybe we can do it. Maybe it was fate?

天意，一个在机械女士看来毫无价值的名词，它仅仅意味着智慧种族在其蒙昧时代的恐惧与臆想。
Fate. Fate has no direction in her view. Ascribing purpose or intention to a chain of events was just a flaw in human reasoning.

露西：我没想过这些。
Lucy: I never considered that.

露西：维克多不想把这件事做下去，那就交给别人做。
Lucy: I had insufficient time to work on it.

露西：没有比你更合适的人选，所以就由你来。就这样。
Lucy: So, I gave it to you. That is all.

露西：1908 年的失败不能说明这条道路是错误的。
Lucy: Where your uncle failed, I had hoped you might succeed.

露西：而维克多放弃了的项目最后又落到了他的亲戚手中，则是个纯粹的意外。
Lucy: There was no notion of destiny. I simply made a practical decision.

露西：或者说，一个纯粹的巧合。
Lucy: And this winged man story is just sensationalist journalism. It was a coincidence.

胡安娜：这事要是让其他神秘学家知道，他们也会认为这是一种天意，是灵知和宿命的回归指引。
Joanna: Say what you will. You may not believe in fate, but plenty of others, humans and arcanists alike, do.

胡安娜：不过无论如何，我让孩子们跟我一起把这件事做下去了，你看——
Joanna: Anyway, fate or not, you should see how far we've come.

学生 II：一分零八秒！是我赢了！
Student II: That makes it one minute and eight seconds! I win!

学生 I：你放屁，明明是一分零一秒！你多报了七秒钟！那时候你还踩在地上！
Student I: Give me a break. That was one minute and one second! You were still on the ground when you started counting!

学生 II：发动机启动的时间就算！
Student II: Yeah, because we agreed to start counting as soon as the engine starts!

露西：离开地面后我们才开始计算滞空时间。
Lucy: That would be unwise. It is more useful to count only after you have achieved lift-off.

露西：否则你会得到错误的实验数据，进而对后续研究产生误导。
Lucy: Otherwise, your records may not accurately show your progress, sending you down the wrong path.

为首的孩子转头看向她，又看向机械女士身后的胡安娜。
The boys turn to the source of the stern yet encouraging voice.

学生 I：你是谁？你——欸？那个机器人！
Student I: Wait, it's that robot from before! Cool!

学生 I：嘿，老师把机器人带来了！
Student I: Hey, everyone! Ms. Joanna brought the robot here!

露西：没有神秘术的辅助也能稳定滞空一分钟以上，嗯，这比以前好了不少。
Lucy: Do you mean that your flight duration now exceeds a minute without aid from arcane skills? Simply astounding.

胡安娜：对露西女士尊重一些。要知道，你们那些宝贝翅膀的原型设计图可是她送来的。
Joanna: You should be saying thanks. It was Ms. Lucy who gave us the original prototype for our wings.

学生 I：好的，老师！
Student I: Of course, thanks, Miss!

学生 II：没问题，老师！
Student II: Yeah, thanks, Miss Robot!

胡安娜：还是老问题：少量液态燃料不能提供足够的续航。
Joanna: You've correctly guessed our biggest obstacle: fuel.

胡安娜：但如果要把油舱做大，需要的动力支持也会随之倍增，得不偿失。
Joanna: We tried enlarging the tank, but the heavier the weight in fuel and material, the less efficient it became. We just can't find a solution that allows for prolonged independent flight.

胡安娜：不过孩子们很有信心，我们有足够的时间来慢慢调整设计。
Joanna: But we're still confident, aren't we, gentlemen?

胡安娜：也许现在还不够完美，没关系，像你说的，这只是个时间问题。他们还很年轻。
Joanna: It's far from perfect now, but that's fine. As you said, it's only a matter of time, and these kids have plenty of that.

胡安娜：十六岁时解决不了的问题，我相信等他们六十岁的时候，就再不是问题了。
Joanna: Think how far they'll have progressed by the time they reach my age. The world could be completely different, even from our wildest dreams.

时间，是的，时间……燃煤取代风和水，燃油和电力又渐渐将煤炭挤下能源的王座。
The march of progress has been undeniable, even contained to just the last century. From whale oil lamps and coal, to gasoline and atomic energy, it is hard to imagine what will come next.

露西：四十四年前人类刚发明了电视机。
Lucy: The television is a great example. It has only been around for 44 years. When it first released, it seemed as though it would never dethrone the cinema.

露西：而现在他们已经离不开晶体管电视和晚上八点的影视剧了。
Lucy: Now it is a staple of modern life. People can hardly spend a day without their favorite shows.

学生 I：你们在聊电视？那你肯定知道詹姆斯·柯克船长和他的斯波克伙计！
Student I: Are you talking about TV shows? Hey Miss, do you know Captain James T. Kirk and Spock?

学生 II：万一她没看过呢？你怎么敢这么断定！这不严谨！
Student II: Why did you ask her? It's a TV show, not real life, doofus. She's a robot, not an actress!

学生 I：她是机器人！怎么可能不知道这——么伟大的科幻片！
Student I: Yeah, I know she's a robot! That's why I figured she'd have to know about the best sci-fi show of all time.

胡安娜：我想，这个话题可以就此打住了，除非你们俩想后天早上去义务打扫学校的游泳池。
Joanna: Let's stop pestering Miss Lucy about her favorite shows, alright boys? Unless, you'd like to spend tomorrow cleaning out the school swimming pool?

胡安娜：对吗，热爱劳动的好孩子们?
Joanna: Sound like fun to you?

一个轻飘飘的威胁，但足够让学生闭上那张叽叽喳喳吵个不停的嘴。
It is a half-joking threat, but enough to bring the boys in line.

露西： 按照安排，他们应该和学校里的其他学生一起观看直播。
Lucy: That would be quite a shame. You would very likely miss the broadcast.

露西： 科算中心打算推行新的测试信号转输技术在十万公里级别距离上的应用。
Lucy: I am very proud to say it is LSCC technology that was pivotal in constructing the signal-boosting devices.

露西： 不过在这之前，先来看看你们的麻烦……
Lucy: But for now, let me see the problem that you have been dealing with.

机械女士走向那两对插在沙地里的金属设备，对人类少年的力气来说，能把上百斤重的装备带来海岸绝非易事。
The mechanical woman walks toward the metal construct lying in the sand.

学生 I： 丹和安妮，还有其他人一起帮忙搬来的。
Student I: Daniel and Annie and the others helped us move it out here.

学生 II： 是的是的，我们答应好了，等翅膀做好，就让大家轮流用，让大家都能飞一飞！
Student II: Yeah. We promised them everyone would get a try after we've ironed out the kinks.

胡安娜： 我帮他们把设备调试到最好了，你看到的就是我们能做到的极限了。
Joanna: We've hit a hard limit now; I've tried everything I could think of to help them.

露西： 一分钟的成绩很不错。你就是为这个邀请我来的吗?
Lucy: One minute is already a remarkable achievement. Is this why you invited me here?

胡安娜： 我很怀念跟你共事的那段日子，露西。
Joanna: Well, that and I miss working with you, Lucy.

胡安娜： 这只是一位早早退休的工程师对她往昔生涯的一种怀念，以及对老朋友的好意。
Joanna: The switch was worth it, believe me. Still, I do miss some parts of my career, and my colleagues.

胡安娜： 当然，在这当中加上一点小小的请求，我想也没什么问题。
Joanna: So, think you can lend us a hand?

露西： 飞行器用的是液态燃料吗?
Lucy: I will attempt to do so. Is it still powered by liquid fuel?

胡安娜： 年初的那个版本是，航空中心的朋友一直在为我们提供少量燃油。
Joanna: Until recently it was. We've actually been getting it straight from the Space Center. So, it was about as high-grade as you can get.

胡安娜： 但最近半年我们发现了问题：燃油的安全性和储能都有问题，所以现在改用电线了。
Joanna: But, we've been toying with something else now. To cut the weight down, we switched to wired electricity.

如她所言，车载发电机延出了长长的黑色电线，连接着人群中央的黑色金属翅膀。
Lucy scans over the beach, finding a long black cord connected from the machine back toward a nearby generator.

露西： 这会限制飞行器的活动范围。
Lucy: A wire? That completely restricts your flight range.

露西： 输电线的极限长度就是飞行器的飞行范围极限。
Lucy: The length of the cord would determine your maximum radius.

露西： ……
Lucy: ...

露西： 你们或许只是做了一个能载人的电动风筝。
Lucy: You have created an electric kite.

胡安娜： 至少把风筝线换成了电线。
Joanna: At least we replaced the thread with a wire.

胡安娜： 是的，电动风筝……他们偶尔就会这样称呼它。但有什么别的办法吗?
Joanna: But you're right. It's nothing more than a kind of powered kite. They even call it that sometimes. But what else can we do?

胡安娜： 电池连接着发电机，只有这样才能稳定提供能源。
Joanna: This was the only solution that gave us any kind of stable flight.

胡安娜： 如果拔掉电线，那就像你刚才看到的：一分钟是大容量化学电池的极限。
Joanna: Once unplugged, the battery can only sustain the engine for less than a minute.

露西： 换句话说，只要能解决这个问题……
Lucy: I see. So, it is not a matter of fuel, but rather of capacity.

露西： 我想这不是一道难题。
Lucy: A simple adjustment will resolve this issue.

机械女士敞开大衣口袋，分享了她为自己储备的收藏：一些块状金属制品，神秘学与材料科学结合的奇迹之一。
She produces a silvery metallic block from her coat, an emergency power source, made from the miraculous fusion of arcanum and material science.

露西： 如果你们用的 T-2 型通用插槽，那它可以完美替代现在的电池。
Lucy: If your design has a T-2 general slot, this battery may work as a substitute.

露西： 把舱盖打开，再把这个放进去。
Lucy: Let me try.

她走向有翼的机器，将新的心脏装入亮银舱盖中。
She skillfully replaces the battery.

接着，她拔下机翼下吊垂着的黑色脐带——
Then unplugs the wings.

露西： 再试试。
Lucy: Try it again.

学生 I： 她换了什么东西进去，电池吗?
Student I: So, what is it? A new battery?

学生 I： 就这么简单?
Student I: Is that going to be enough?

露西： 这应该能解决了。
Lucy: I am confident it will dramatically improve your flight time.

露西： 不要飞得太高，也不要远离海岸，控制好时间。
Lucy: However, I suggest you do not fly too high or too far away from the beach, at least until we know the precise power draw.

胡安娜向她走来，而两名学生则跑向各自的机器，准备试试机械女士为他们提供的新玩意儿。
Joanna and the students crowd around the wings to see the new component.

胡安娜： 那是什么？我没听说过航天基地在研究电池技术……
Joanna: I didn't know the Space Center had been working on battery technology.

露西： 是我和科算中心在 1965 年完成的一个项目。
Lucy: Actually, this is a product I developed with the LSCC in 1965.

露西：有赖于神秘学家同事的协助，这种电池突破了某些物理材料的限制。
Lucy: An arcanist colleague there helped me complete this project. The arcanum imbued in it should allow it to ignore the usual physical limits of its material.

胡安娜：神秘学家？噢，那这东西已经到量产阶段了？
Joanna: I can only imagine what could be done with technology like that. Has it been released?

露西：很快就会，行政部门正在处理相关的文书工作，技术上完全成熟。
Lucy: We have begun mass production. We are only waiting for official permission to make it publicly available.

露西：稳定可控的神秘术咒文和基地仓库里存放的航空燃油没有区别。
Lucy: By harnessing arcanum, we were able to achieve a similar energy density to rocket fuel, but without the need for cumbersome tanks and piping.

露西：石油工业构筑起了现代文明的基石，那么已经解明了的、能够完美重现的神秘术也可以作为这栋大厦的支柱。
Lucy: Petroleum was a marvel of science that laid the foundation for modern civilization. That being the case, I believe that if arcane skills could be studied comprehensively and replicated, they might be capable of supplanting fossil fuel entirely.

胡安娜：我还以为你会反对神秘术在科学领域的应用。
Joanna: I always thought you refused to use arcane skills to enhance technology?

露西：加上定语，“不稳定的”神秘术。
Lucy: I opposed the use of arcane skill only because it was unstable and not replicable at scale.

露西：当我们找到了控制它的方法，它就是一项可供利用的助力，像河流驱动大坝，一旦驯服洪水，大河就是我们的发电机。
Lucy: However, if it can be incorporated into technology in a controllable and generalized way, it can work.

露西：而人类或是神秘学家，或是一台电冰箱，胡安娜，我不认为有什么不同。
Lucy: The gap between arcane skills and human technologies is really not so different, no more than that between a human brain and a computer.

露西：数字编码设计的智能机械和基因编码创造出的智能生物，本质上说，一样。
Lucy: One is created through genetic coding, while the other is created by digital coding. They are essentially the same.

胡安娜：……
Joanna: ...

胡安娜：如果换别人说这种话，我一定会认为他疯了。
Joanna: If it were anyone else saying that, I'd have called them a nut job.

露西：是吗?
Lucy: Why?

露西：语言不会因人而异。
Lucy: A fact remains a fact, regardless of who says it.

露西：机械装置在不同的人手中都有着同样的性能。
Lucy: And a mechanical device has the same function, no matter its user.

胡安娜：每个孩子都能握着操纵杆享受俯瞰海岸的快乐。
Joanna: That much is true. But we're getting ahead of ourselves. We still need to see the results of our test flight.

铝翼的飞鸟从海岸缓缓飞起。在秒表计时的紧张计数中，人群数出了一个又一个百秒的极限数字。
In a short time, the first brave pilot takes off on his aluminum wings. The students cheer as the stopwatch counts up to 60 seconds and then beyond.

露西：是的，你的学生很享受飞行。
Lucy: It seems like a remarkable success.

胡安娜：是啊，很享受……一种纯粹的快乐，不为了跟外国人竞争，不为政治宣传而飞。
Joanna: This will be the end of an era. No more competition. Just fun.

露西：它完成得比我想象中轻松很多。
Lucy: I think we can call our project completed.

胡安娜：水到渠成嘛。
Joanna: Well, only thanks to you.

露西：要我替你把相关设计提交给航天基地吗？科算中心也行。
Lucy: Do you want me to report this achievement to the Space Center? Or maybe the LSCC.

胡安娜：不用，我想再等等，有些东西还可以再优化。对了，你预计它能飞多久？
Joanna: Not quite yet. There's still room for improvement. So how long do you think that battery can last now?

露西：我不知道，但肯定比你们之前久得多。
Lucy: We will need to do further testing to determine that; however, I suspect it is an improvement by orders of magnitude.

胡安娜：那就叫他们下来。这些孩子一激动就容易沉浸在飞行里，趁他们还没被冲昏脑子……
Joanna: Then maybe I should call him down. Just to be safe.

胡安娜：山姆，下来。丹和彼得帮帮忙，清理沙滩，让山姆落地，欢迎我们的英雄——
Joanna: Jack, get down here. Danny, Peter, please clear the beach off for landing.

有翼的小飞人听到老师呼唤，不情不愿地带着身后的金属机械回到沙滩，稳稳落回大地母亲的怀抱。
Reluctantly, the young man returns from the sky, making a steady landing on the sand.

露西：十分零四十八秒，不错的成绩。
Lucy: Ten minutes and 48 seconds. That makes for quite a new record.

胡安娜：下一次我们会做得更好，一定会。
Joanna: I'm certain they'll have beat that handily before you know it.

# 漫步 1969
## Roaming through 1969 CH19601-08

漫步 1969
Roaming through 1969

……

...

露西：胡安娜——
Lucy: Joanna.

胡安娜：门没锁，你自己进来吧。
Joanna: It's open. Come in.

机械女士应声进入老朋友的旧宅。
The mechanical woman enters her friend's house.

1969，胡安娜宅
Joanna's Home, 1969

露西： 你把电视搬到了二楼吗?
Lucy: Did you move the TV upstairs?

她环视屋内，处处陈列整齐，屋子打扫得干干净净，却独独不见屋主人所在。
She stands in a tidy living room, but there is no sign of her host.

胡安娜： 是的，是……天线卡住了，噢，上回迈克尔没修好它，我们就这么扔二楼了……
Joanna: Yeah. The antenna's stuck. Michael couldn't fix it, so we brought it up here, where it could catch the signal.

胡安娜： 上来吧，露西，我得折腾折腾这玩意儿，很快，我保证……
Joanna: Come on up, Lucy. I'm trying to get this darned thing working. It won't take long, I promise.

露西： 要我帮忙吗?
Lucy: Are you in need of help?

胡安娜： 我快弄好了，快了，就是差点儿，有颗螺丝不太听话！坏孩子！你最好老实点……！
Joanna: It's okay. I'm almost done. It's just this screw. It won't get in there—don't make me get rough with you, you naughty garoto!

机械女士坐到一旁，时针指向四点十一分。她几乎能想象到航天基地里的繁忙景象。
The mechanical woman sits down and looks at the clock. It is 4:11 in the afternoon. She can easily imagine how busy her colleagues are at the Space Center.

露西： 他们离月面应该很近了。
Lucy: They should be close to landing on the moon now.

胡安娜： 是的，很近了，马上就拧紧了……很近了！
Joanna: Yeah, close. I'm close to making it work. Done!

火花一闪，电线似乎有意不遂人意，以一次小小的爆闪嘲笑设备主人的努力。
The wires spark and burn. It strikes the woman like mocking laughter.

露西： 很遗憾，它坏掉了。
Lucy: It appears to be broken.

露西： 我能修好这东西。
Lucy: A simple adjustment will resolve this issue.

胡安娜： 行！吧！那吃点东西，我再想想办法。或者，你来想想办法?
Joanna: Alrighty then! Let's grab something to eat first, and then we'll see what I can do, or I guess, what you can do.

胡安娜： 来点玉米糊？葡萄牙的亲戚寄过来的，好吧，我知道这有点怪，但你要来点吗?
Joanna: Would you like to try some pamonha? It's an old family recipe from Portugal.

露西： 我不需要摄入食物补充能量，胡安娜。不用了。
Lucy: I do not need food to replenish energy, Joanna. But, thank you.

胡安娜： 抱歉抱歉，我差点忘了，你……
Joanna: Oh, I completely forgot, haha.

胡安娜： 偶尔像人类一样吃点东西，或许也不坏？随你吧，哈哈。
Joanna: But it can't hurt to have something to eat, right? You are capable of it after all. Anyways, it's your call.

露西： 蛋白质的能量转化效率比电力和热能低太多了。
Lucy: Biological material has a much lower conversion efficiency than pure electricity.

在最近的一个百年里，这是她受益最深的一次革新：将身体改换由伟大的电力驱动，由此得到了数十倍于以往的续航能力。
It had been a century since she had changed her primary power source. It had increased her capacity exponentially.

而代价，则是某种近似人性的焦虑悄悄在她纯粹理性的大脑中诞生了——电量焦虑。
Yet it came with an unexpected price: she no longer felt welcome at meal times. Humans consider fuel consumption a social activity, and some take offense to her abstaining.

露西：也许未来我们可以开发一些更便捷的高能餐食，以节省不必要的用餐时间。
Lucy: Perhaps high-nutrient foods will become more popular in the future. That way, less time will be wasted on social consumption rituals.

胡安娜：好了，吃饭是生活的享受。品尝美食有助于身心健康。
Joanna: Oh please, food isn't just about the health of your body. It's good for your spirit too! It's one of the great joys of living.

露西：航天食品是不错的成果，用最小的体积提供了最丰富的营养以维持生存——
Lucy: Irrelevant. Whatever a spirit is, it is not nourished by biological matter. Now, consider the food we prepared for the astronauts, lightweight but densely-packed with nutrients—

胡安娜：好好好，露西女士，那么你能把这玩意儿折腾好吗？我不想错过直播。
Joanna: Fine, no pamonha for you. Now would you fix this machine? I don't want to miss the broadcast.

露西：修好的概率大于百分之九十五，但不保证大于百分之九十八，它有失败的可能……
Lucy: Yes. It is possible. However, I must warn you, there is a small chance of failure. I predict between 2 to 5%.

胡安娜：我给乔治打了电话，待会儿他会送替换零件来，总之我们先……先让这金属盒子开机。
Joanna: Well, I already called the repairman. But if you don't mind trying your luck, maybe you can give it a whirl first?

机械女士的手伸向那颗不起眼的小螺丝，殖民时代的老屋中涌出了来自十八世纪的滚滚蒸汽，随着呜呜汽鸣，神秘术的光辉似乎将要唤醒金属造物的意识——
The mechanical woman reaches for the stubborn screw, and steam pours out from her core. The light of arcane skill seems to awaken the machine, and then ...

一个小概率的意外在白色汽烟中发生了。
In a fit of sputtering smoke, the unlikeliest probability seems to have come to pass.

胡安娜：咳……咳……嘿，露西，发生什么了？
Joanna: *coughs* What's happening, Lucy?

露西：……我想，可能是神秘术失败了。
Lucy: My arcane skill has failed.

一个指头大小的人型生物站在木地板上。她由铁青色的金属塑成，不比身旁那颗从蒸汽中滚落的活塞核心大上多少。
A finger-sized robot now stands motionless next to a piston where Lucy had been. The piston squeaks up to Joanna from the ground.

露西：超过四十二个月又十八天没有发生这种状况了。
Lucy: It has been 42 months and 18 days since the last time this failure occurred.

露西：……
Lucy: ...

露西：真糟糕。
Lucy: How unfortunate.

胡安娜：……你以前从没跟我说过会发生这种事。
Joanna: Seems like we made a bad gamble, haha.

胡安娜：你看起来就像个模型……还……还蛮可爱的，露西！
Joanna: But it isn't so bad. Why, you almost look like a little dolly now. Very, very cute, Miss Lucy.

胡安娜：但你……怎么变回来？
Joanna: But, how do you get back to your usual size?

露西：两分钟或者三分钟，别担心。
Lucy: It will be over in just a few minutes. Do not be concerned.

胡安娜：嗯……我又认识了一个不太一样的你。
Joanna: I never expected to learn something new about you after all these years.

露西：我只是一枚金属活塞。
Lucy: I am no more than a metal piston truly. Everything else is just a mechanical construction. A facade.

一枚从启蒙余晖中苏醒的活塞，恰如此时此刻……
She looks now just as she did when she was first awakened.

二百年的历史凝滞在这栋老屋中，工程师家族在佛罗里达海岸放下了第一台蒸汽机。
When she took form as a part of that very first steam engine.

三秒后，机械女士睁开双眼，金属螺丝被胡安娜重新捡起。
A few seconds pass, and Joanna picks up the tiny, immobile robot.

胡安娜：我简直想象不到这小东西刚才变成了你……
Joanna: I still can't believe this little thing was you.

露西：不稳定的神秘术意外。
Lucy: An accident caused by a rare instability with my arcane skill.

露西：所以它不能被应用于重要场合，我们不能把成功的筹码压在不可靠的天平上。
Lucy: I suppose you see now why I am reluctant to use my skills, even when they are important. It is dangerous to bet on an uncertainty.

胡安娜：修个电视，没问题吧？再来一次，刚才不过是一个小小的意外。
Joanna: Thankfully it's only a TV this time. Not that big a deal, right? Besides, it was only a tiny, little accident. You can always try again.

如她所说。蒸汽再一次从机械活塞中涌出，神秘术的辉光将沉默的显像管唤醒。
Once again, Lucy emits steam from her core, this time successfully reactivating the television with her arcane skill.

露西：这就好了。
Lucy: Done.

信号从三十万公里外传来，黑白画面中，身着厚重宇航服的男人即将走下登陆舱。
A signal reaches the TV from 300,000 kilometers away. On the black-and-white screen, a man begins to step out from a capsule, his feet landing on the surface of the moon.

一种宁静的荒凉随着天外信号传回人类的母星，呈映在金属屏幕里。
The camera captures not only the capsule and the astronaut, but the silence and loneliness of space.

胡安娜：那儿很美。
Joanna: It looks so beautiful up there.

胡安娜：东方人说月亮上有桂树，还有宫殿和住在宫殿里的公主，公主养着兔子……
Joanna: In some many different cultures, people believed something was living on the moon. In China, they say there's a palace on the moon, with a princess and a rabbit.

露西： 荒凉的月球表面不可能生长植物，更不可能饲养家禽。
Lucy: There is no breathable atmosphere on the moon. Such a thing would be logically impossible.

胡安娜： 他们下去了！
Joanna: Well, we're about to see. They're taking the first steps now.

那是小之又小的一步，来自三十万公里外的蓝色行星，将那颗星球上以万年计的无数仰望与幻想化为了脚下的现实。
It may only be one small step for man, but for mankind, it is a journey of many thousand years.

机械女士站在一旁，无声地注视着登月小组在月面漫步。
She watches as the astronauts take their first clumsy steps across the moonscape.

露西： 那时你们只能望着天空叹息，而现在，胡安娜，你们已经把手伸向了无垠的星海。
Lucy: It was less than 70 years, Joanna, when most people believed humanity would never fly. And now, you have taken the first step on another world.

胡安娜却转身指向卧室墙上的壁挂油画。
Joanna is still silent in awe of the moment, but in a short while, she points over to a painting on the wall.

胡安娜： 维克多叔公雇人画了一幅画，喏，就是这个。
Joanna: That painting was from Uncle Victor.

一幅油画，比这儿的女主人更年长，陪伴胡安娜走过了漫长的军旅生涯与科研岁月。
A painting that has kept her company throughout her life.

身负双翼的少女从海港起航，飞过灯塔，飞往太阳，仿佛神话中的代达罗斯之子。
Depicted on it, a winged girl taking off into a harbor, flying past a lighthouse, heading toward the sun.

胡安娜： 来自我们家族的一位先祖，传说她是第一个飞起来的人。
Joanna: They say she's an ancestor of our family, from Portugal. That she was the first human to truly fly.

一朵遥远的、几乎快被遗忘在岁月长河中的水花。
There was no question in Lucy's mind of who this mysterious woman had been. It was a remarkable likeness of the scene.

露西： 1835 年我从里斯本起航，在那儿和希梅娜制作了飞行翼的雏形。
Lucy: I started this project in 1835 in Lisbon. Jimena and I made the first prototype of those wings.

露西： 但那时我们只能靠风力来驱动翅膀。
Lucy: There was no engine in the first designs. We could only catch the wind.

露西： 最后是神秘术完成了那个遗憾的发明，希梅娜乘着翅膀飞上了开往新大陆的船。
Lucy: It was something of a bitter moment—I had to use my arcane skill to alter it so that Jimena could reach her ship. I never saw her again. I did not even know if she survived.

胡安娜： ……
Joanna: ...

胡安娜： 那是你吗，露西?
Joanna: I knew she had a partner, somehow, I never realized it was you.

露西： 七十年后，维克多捡起了这个念头，我们试着使用燃油来提供动力。
Lucy: I spent a lot of time on other work after that. By the time I heard about your uncle's project, it had been 70 years.

露西：但笨重的机械外壳和脆弱的金属管道根本无法支撑长时间飞行，于是他放弃了。
Lucy: But still, we could not solve the problem of power. The technology just was not available to lift the frame for any significant length of time. He gave up.

胡安娜：维克多叔公后来成了一位成功的商人，在纽约做橄榄油生意……
Joanna: Did you know after he left Boston, Uncle Victor went to New York, made it rich with some olive oil business?

露西：是吗？恭喜他。
Lucy: No, I never knew. But I am happy for him.

一个成功的商人，一位失败的发明家。
So, he achieved his goals after all. Just like Jimena did, in a way.

露西：他那时一直在思考飞行翼的商业价值。
Lucy: He had always realized the business value of the wings.

露西：而对世纪初的科技积累来说，很遗憾，那仍然是个不可能完成的梦想。
Lucy: But he came to believe that it was impossible to achieve the design with the technology we had available.

露西：对人类有限的寿命来说，未来的确太过遥远。
Lucy: Humans have so little time, when you look at it. The future is always slipping out of their grasps.

露西：他们承受不住一百次、一千次乃至上万次的失败，借此来验证一个尚未成熟的项目。
Lucy: It is understandable why they grow frustrated after failing again and again. They do not have the time to wait around for the next miracle.

胡安娜：可我们总会有抵达古老而遥远的梦想的那一天。喏，孩子们在天上飞得很开心。
Joanna: But by handing down that ember, through you, he helped us get here. Now we've realized his dream, and Jimena's, and her father's before her.

露西：这或许会走很久，这是一条长之又长的路。
Lucy: Yes, ideas, too, have a process of slow iteration.

露西：十九世纪的人认为飞起来是了不起的。
Lucy: In the 19th century, only a few people even dreamed that humans would ever fly.

露西：二十世纪初的人认为能飞得久一些是一项不可能完成的任务。
Lucy: In your uncle's time, it had already changed. People knew it was possible, but thought it would only ever be a novelty.

露西：在一个半世纪的尺度下，艰难而缓慢地踏步在这条路上。
Lucy: Now, no one doubts where we can go.

露西：这是一个时间问题，胡安娜。
Lucy: It is always only a matter of time, Joanna.

时间推着人们顺流而下，哪怕有人行至半途便不敢迈步向前。
And time moves all, like a river. It cannot be stopped, and no one can control where it will take us.

哪怕有人在那高山前低头，为近在跟前的面包放弃了远眺高天的梦想。
No matter whether you rage against it, take every moment you can, or give up halfway.

露西：简单的时间问题。
Lucy: All that we need is patience.

胡安娜：我们总会抵达终点，即便在那之前有无数双翅膀被折断在海风中。
Joanna: We will eventually get there, even though many of us may fall along the way.

胡安娜： 你见证了这一切，露西。
Joanna: But you witnessed it all, Lucy. You kept that ember glowing.
露西： 我只是在你们身旁。
Lucy: I just kept you company along the way.
露西： 与你们一路同行。
Lucy: That is all I did.